Braided module categories from small braidings

Tyler Franke[1]*, Ingo Runkel[1], Volker Schomerus[2]

[1] *Fachbereich Mathematik, Universität Hamburg,*
Bundesstraße 55, 20146 Hamburg, Germany

[2] *Deutsches Elektronen-Synchroton DESY,*
Notekestraße 85, 22607 Hamburg, Germany

October 28, 2026

Abstract

We introduce small braidings on inclusions of monoidal categories $\mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}$, which allow one to braid objects in $\mathcal{C}$ with objects in $\mathcal{D}$. A small braiding makes $\mathcal{C}$ a braided monoidal category, and $\mathcal{D}$, as well as certain subcategories of $\mathcal{D}$, a braided module category. We prove versions of previously known reconstruction results for braided module categories which do not rely on finiteness assumptions. We construct a number of new examples coming from quantum groups, and recover quantum group equivariant quantisations of conjugacy classes of Lie groups studied by Donin and Mudrov.

Contents

1 Introduction **2**
1.1 Outlook 4
1.2 Organisation 5

2 Categorical preliminaries **6**
2.1 Braided module categories 6
2.2 Half-braided algebras and quantum moment maps 9
2.3 Small braidings 24

*tyler.franke@uni-hamburg.de

3 Braided module categories for quantum groups **30**
3.1 Small braidings from unrolled quantum groups 30
3.2 Examples for generic quantum parameter 32
3.3 Quantum moment maps from internal-homs 35

A Closed monoidal categories **40**

1 Introduction

Braided monoidal categories can be thought of as monoidal categories which provide representations of the braid group of Coxeter type A [JS93]. Adopting this intuition, *braided module categories*, first introduced in [En08], extend these representations to representations of the braid group of type B [Br13].

Braided module categories arise naturally in the Morita theory of braided monoidal categories; They are objects in the endomorphism category of the identity morphism in the 4-category of braided tensor categories [Jo23, Sec. 3.3][BJS18], or objects in the centre of the category of module categories over a braided monoidal category [DN21, Thm. 4.11]. Braided module categories have provided a categorical interpretation of quantum K-matrices [Ko17, LWY23], and have found applications in quantum topology [BZBJ18b], and category theory [JFR23].

In this paper we devise a new construction for braided module categories. The key idea goes as follows: Let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ be monoidal categories and let there be an inclusion of monoidal categories $\mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}$. We define a *small braiding* (Definition 2.17) which allows one to braid objects in $\mathcal{C}$ with objects in $\mathcal{D}$. A small braiding equips $\mathcal{C}$ with a braiding and any subcategory of $\mathcal{D}$ which is closed under tensoring with objects in $\mathcal{C}$ the structure of a braided module category. An advantage of this construction is that it does not rely on finiteness or linearity assumptions for the categories in question. As far as the authors are aware, current systematic approaches for constructing braided module categories result in a category which is the category of finite-dimensional modules over an algebra [Ko17, LWY23], or locally finite-dimensional modules [BZBJ18b] (see also [BZBJ18a, Sec. 1.3.2]).

Let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ be abelian categories and the inclusion $\mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be right exact. Given an algebra $A \in \mathcal{D}$, the category $\mathcal{D}_A$ of A-modules in $\mathcal{D}$ is a $\mathcal{D}$-module category. Furthermore, since $\mathcal{C}$ is a monoidal subcategory, $\mathcal{D}_A$ is also a $\mathcal{C}$-module category. If the algebra A is in the image of the inclusion $\mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}$, module braidings for $\mathcal{D}_A$ are known to be in bijection with half-braidings [JFR23, Sec. 2.5], and quantum moment maps when $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon [BZBJ18b, Cor. 4.11] (see Proposition 2.8 and Definition 2.12 for the definitions of these terms). If A is not in the image of the inclusion, we obtain a weaker result: A half-braiding for A results in a canonical module braiding for $\mathcal{D}_A$. It remains true that if $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon half-braidings for A

are in bijection with quantum moment maps.

The definition of a small braiding is motivated by observing that the braiding for quantum groups $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ with generic quanutm parameter q is well-defined on a tensor product of type 1 modules if at least one of the modules is finite-dimensional. We extend this result to braid weight modules with generic weights by showing that the category of type 1 modules for $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ monoidally includes into the category of weight modules for the unrolled quantum group $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$. From this we obtain the following small braiding:

Theorem (Theorem 3.3)**.** Let $\mathcal{C}$ be the category of finite-dimensional $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-modules of type 1 and $\mathcal{D}^H$ the category $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-weight modules. For generic quantum parameter q, there is a small braiding on the monoidal inclusion $\mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}^H$ given by

$$\overrightarrow{\sigma}_{U,V}(u \otimes v) = s_{U,V} q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i (A^{-1})_{ij} H_i \otimes H_j} R \cdot (u \otimes v) \tag{1.1a}$$

$$\overleftarrow{\sigma}_{V,U}(v \otimes u) = s_{V,U} q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i (A^{-1})_{ij} H_i \otimes H_j} R \cdot (v \otimes u)\ , \tag{1.1b}$$

where R is the R-matrix for $U_q\mathfrak{g}$.

Using the above theorem and basic facts about the representation theory of $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ at generic quantum parameter q we describe several concrete examples coming from this small braiding:

- (Example 3.4) $\mathcal{O}_q^H$ the quantum category $\mathcal{O}$ of [AM14, Def. 3.1] for the unrolled quantum group.
- (Example 3.5) Given $\Lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*/\sim$, where $\lambda \sim \mu$ if $\lambda - \mu$ is integral, $\mathcal{D}_\Lambda^H$ the full subcategory of $\mathcal{D}^H$ of modules with weight support in Λ.
- (Example 3.7) For $\Lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*/\sim$ containing only generic weights, $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda^H$ the full subcategory of $\mathcal{D}_\Lambda^H$ with objects isomorphic to a direct sum of Verma modules with highest weights in Λ.

In the Appendix we review how internal-end objects $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,V) =: \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$ in a monoidal category $\mathcal{D}$, if they exist, come with the canonical structure of an algebra, and how the internal-hom functor $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,-) : \mathcal{D} \to \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}$ comes with a canonical natural transformation $\Phi_{U,W} : \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, U \otimes W) \to U \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,W)$. In Lemma A.5 we show that $\Phi_{U,W}$ is an isomorphism if and only if U has a left dual. Hence $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,-)$ is a module functor if and only if we are considering $\mathcal{D}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,V)}$ as module categories over a left-rigid monoidal subcategory of $\mathcal{D}$. In the $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ setting described above, $\mathcal{C}$ is precisely the full subcategory of left-rigid objects in $\mathcal{D}$. It is then natural to ask if internal-homs exist in $\mathcal{D}$, and whether we can equip them with quantum moment maps such that $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,-)$ becomes a braided module functor.

We are able to construct quantum moment maps from the $\hbar$-adic Hopf algebra $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$, where $q = e^\hbar$ is now a formal parameter instead of a complex number. We use the fact that the category $\mathcal{D}$ of topologically-free modules is closed monoidal to construct quantum moment maps for internal endomorphism algebras $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$. Because the representation theory of topologically-free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ weight modules mimics that of $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-weight modules, we are also able to work with the above examples in the $\hbar$-adic setting. We then construct half-braidings using a small braiding between the category of finite-dimensional topologically-free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules and $\mathcal{D}$. Since $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon, we arrive at the following theorem.

Theorem 1.1. (Theorem 3.10) Let $\mathcal{D}$ be the category of topologically-free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules and $\mathcal{C}$ be the category of finite-dimensional topologically-free $U_\hbar g$-modules. For all $V \in \mathcal{D}$ there is a canonical quantum moment map for the internal-endomorphism algebra $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$ of V. Taking V to be a generalised Verma module, the quantum moment map for $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$ recovers the quantised conjugacy classes of Lie groups defined in [Mu07].

In Proposition 3.11 we observe that the braided module category $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda$ satisfies sufficient conditions (Proposition A.7) such that the functor $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V(\lambda), -) : \mathcal{M}_\Lambda \to \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V(\Lambda))}$ is a fully faithful braided $\mathcal{C}$-module functor.

1.1 Outlook

Our main motivation comes from an application in defect skein theory. Namely, organising defect data of skein modules according to the Morita theory of braided tensor categories [BJS18], one is is lead to label line defects with braided module categories and junctions between line defects with braided module functors. In future work, the authors intend to study examples of defect skein modules with defect data coming from the examples discussed here. See [BZBJ18b, BJ25, G26, KR26, BGJM26, CJR26] for previous work of a similar flavour on defect skein modules.

We approach a reconstruction result for $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda$ by fully including it into the category of modules over an algebra, with the inclusion being a braided module functor. The obstruction to turning this into an honest reconstruction result (equivalence of braided module categories) is the same as the reason that small braidings are interesting: The categories in question are non-finite. Tools for monadic reconstruction of module categories were developed in [SZ26] precisely in order to deal with non-finite and non-rigid settings. Developing these tools for braided module categories therefore has a natural application in our setting.

The quantum group setting is amenable to constructing many more examples of braided module categories from small braidings. One could study the fusion rules for generlised Verma modules in [Mu07, Prop. 3.7] to construct braided module

categories similar to $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda$. These examples should also have counterparts when the quantum parameter is specialised to a complex number. Examples beyond highest weight modules could be constructed by studying the fusion rules of the torsion-free modules of [FHW15] with finite-dimensional modules. Furthermore, all of these examples will admit quantum moment maps in the $\hbar$-adic setting, which provide more quantum group equivariant coadjoint orbits of Lie groups à la [DM02, Mu07].

The example $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda$ for $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sl}_2$ has appeared under various guises in the literature, without the braided module category structure being recognised: The category $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda$ describes boundary conditions for the XXZ spin chain [CGS22], one can find in its morphism spaces the blob algebra [MS94], and morphism spaces of the blob category of [ILZ19, LNV21]. It would be interesting to explore these connections more deeply.

1.2 Organisation

In Section 2.1 we review the basics of braided module categories and braided module functors. Then in Section 2.2 we review the construction of braided module categories via half-braided algebras and quantum moment maps, and braided module functors via half-braided bimodules. We then introduce small braidings in Section 2.3, and establish generalised versions of half-braided algebras, quanutum moment maps, and half-braided bimodules in this setting. In Section 3 we study braided module categories coming from quantum groups. We begin by discussing the small braiding between finite-dimensional type 1 modules for $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ and weight modules for $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ in Section 3.1. We then introduce concrete examples in this setting in Section 3.2. We conclude in Section 3.3 by switching settings to the $\hbar$-adic quantum group, where we construct half-braided algebras and quantum moment maps using the internal-homs. In Appendix A we prove some results about algebras in closed categories which we use in Section 3.3.

Acknowledgements

TF & IR thank Kevin Walker and Patrick Kinnear for discussions. TF thanks Christopher Raymond for discussions about the representation theory of quantum groups, and Mateusz Stroiński and Tony Zorman for discussions about braided module categories. TF, IR & VS are funded by the Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft (DFG, German Research Foundation) – SFB 1624 – "Higher structures, moduli spaces and integrability" – 506632645.

AI usage disclosure

During the preparation of this manuscript we used Claude to search for relevant literature. None of the text or diagrams in this manuscript are generated by AI. We hold full responsibility for the validity of the results in this manuscript.

2 Categorical preliminaries

In this section we review the notion of a braided module category over a braided monoidal category and its corresponding graphical calculus. We then review the results of [BZBJ18b] and [JFR23] which construct braided module categories from so-called quantum moment maps and half-braided algebras respectively. Finally, we define small braidings, and develop the analogues of quanutum moment maps and half-braided algebras in this new setting.

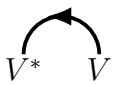
Given a category $\mathcal{C} \ni U, V$, we denote the space of morphisms $U \to V$ as $\mathcal{C}(U, V)$. for Our convention for a braided monoidal category $(\mathcal{C}, \otimes, \mathbb{1}, \alpha, l, r, \sigma)$ follow those of [Ka95, Ch.s XI & XII]. Namely, the direction of the associator is

$$\alpha : (- \otimes =) \otimes = \Rightarrow - \otimes (= \otimes =) \tag{2.1}$$

Our convention and notation for a rigid monoidal category is the same as that of [EGNO15, Sec. 2.10]. We define a ribbon category as in [EGNO15, Def. 8.10.1]. We abbreviate the idenitity morphism on objects id_V by simply writing the object V when there is no ambiguity in doing so.

We frequently employ a digrammatic calculus for braided and rigid monoidal categories. Diagrams are to be read from the bottom up, with the structural morphisms being depicted

$\sigma_{U,V} =$ 

, $\mathrm{ev}_V =$ 

, $\mathrm{coev}_V =$ 

. (2.2)

2.1 Braided module categories

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a braided monoidal category.

Definition 2.1. ([EGNO15, Def. 7.1.2]) A *(left) $\mathcal{C}$-module category* is a category $\mathcal{M}$ along with an *action bifunctor* $- \triangleright = : \mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{M} \to \mathcal{M}$ and a *modulator*, which is a natural isomorphism

$$\alpha^{\mathcal{M}} : (- \otimes =) \triangleright \equiv \Rightarrow - \triangleright (= \triangleright \equiv) , \tag{2.3}$$

as well as a unitor isomorphism $r^{\mathcal{M}} : \mathbb{1} \triangleright - \Rightarrow \mathrm{id}_{\mathcal{M}}$. The modulator is required to satisfy the mixed pentagon identity, and the unit isomorphism the mixed triangle identity, both of which can be found in [EGNO15, Sec. 7.1].

Definition 2.2. A *$\mathcal{C}$-module functor* $F : (\mathcal{M}, \triangleright) \to (\mathcal{N}, \triangleright)$ is a functor $F : \mathcal{M} \to \mathcal{N}$ together with a natural isomorphism $F_{-,=} : - \triangleright F(=) \Rightarrow F(- \triangleright =)$ such that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & (U \otimes V) \triangleright F(M) & \\ {\scriptstyle \alpha^{\mathcal{N}}}\swarrow & & \searrow{\scriptstyle F_{U\otimes V,M}} \\ U \triangleright (V \triangleright F(M)) & & F((U \otimes V) \triangleright M) \\ {\scriptstyle U\triangleright F_{V,M}}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle F(\alpha^{\mathcal{M}})} \\ U \triangleright F(V \triangleright M) & \xrightarrow{F_{U,V\triangleright M}} & F(U \triangleright (V \triangleright M)) \end{array} \tag{2.4}$$

commutes for all objects U, V in $\mathcal{C}$ and M in $\mathcal{M}$.

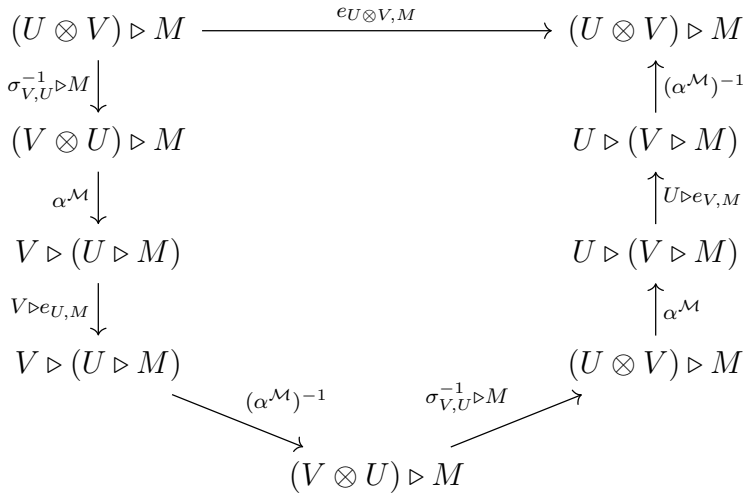
Example 2.3. ([EGNO15, Sec. 7.8]) Assume $\mathcal{C}$ is in addition abelian and that the tensor product is right exact. Let (A, m, u) be an algebra in $\mathcal{C}$. The category $\mathcal{C}_A$ of right A-modules in $\mathcal{C}$ is a left $\mathcal{C}$-module category. Let (B, m', u') be another algebra in $\mathcal{C}$ and M be an (A, B)-bimodule in $\mathcal{C}$. The functor $- \otimes_A M : \mathcal{C}_A \to \mathcal{C}_B$ is a $\mathcal{C}$-module functor.

Definition 2.4. A *(left) braided $\mathcal{C}$-module category* is a $\mathcal{C}$-module category $(\mathcal{M}, \triangleright, \alpha^{\mathcal{M}}, r^{\mathcal{M}})$ along with a *module braiding*, which is a natural automorphism of the action functor

$$e_{-,=} : - \triangleright = \to - \triangleright = , \tag{2.5}$$

such that the diagrams

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} (U \otimes V) \triangleright M & \xrightarrow{\alpha^{\mathcal{M}}} & U \triangleright (V \triangleright M) & \xrightarrow{e_{U,V\triangleright M}} & U \triangleright (V \triangleright M) & \xrightarrow{(\alpha^{\mathcal{M}})^{-1}} & (U \otimes V) \triangleright M \\ {\scriptstyle \sigma_{U,V}\triangleright M}\downarrow & & & & & & \uparrow{\scriptstyle \sigma_{V,U}\triangleright M} \\ (V \otimes U) \triangleright M & \xrightarrow[\alpha^{\mathcal{M}}]{} & V \triangleright (U \triangleright M) & \xrightarrow[V\triangleright e_{U,M}]{} & V \triangleright (U \triangleright M) & \xrightarrow[(\alpha^{\mathcal{M}})^{-1}]{} & (V \otimes U) \triangleright M \end{array} \tag{2.6a}$$



(2.6b)

commute for all $M \in \mathcal{M}$ and $X, Y \in \mathcal{C}$.

Note that naturality of the associativity ismorphisms and condition (2.6b) for $U = V = \mathbb{1}$ implies $e_{\mathbb{1},M} = e_{\mathbb{1},M} \circ e_{\mathbb{1},M}$. Since $e_{\mathbb{1},M}$ is an isomorphism, $e_{\mathbb{1},M} = \mathrm{id}_M$.

Remark 2.5. Braided module categories were first introduced in [En08]. Several different conventions have emerged regarding their definition, the complete list (to the authors' knowledge) being [En08, Sec. 4.3], [Br13, Sec. 5.1], [BZBJ18b, Def. 3.4], [Ko17, Def. 2.1], [DN21, Def. 4.1], [JFR23, Sec. 2.2] and [LWY23, Def. 3.5]. We choose the same convention as [LWY23, Def. 3.5], allowing for $\mathcal{C}$ to be a braided module category over itself with module braiding $e_{U,V} = \sigma_{V,U} \circ \sigma_{U,V}$. Every definition listed is equivalent when the appropriate assumptions are made on $\mathcal{C}$, see [LWY23, Rem. 3.15] for a detailed comparison.

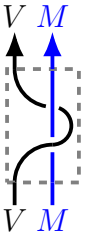
Remark 2.6. It is a standard result that any monoidal category is monoidally equivalent to a strict monoidal category (see for example [EGNO15, Thm. 2.8.5]). A similar result applies for module categories: A $\mathcal{C}$-module category is equivalent to a module category over the strictification of $\mathcal{C}$ such that the mixed associator and unitor are identities [Br13, Section 5.1]. We call such a module category a *strict module category*.

Definition 2.7. A $\mathcal{C}$-module functor $F : (\mathcal{M}, \triangleright) \to (\mathcal{N}, \triangleright')$ of braided module categories $(\mathcal{M}, e)$ and $(\mathcal{N}, e')$ is *braided* if the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} V \triangleright' F(M) & \xrightarrow{e'_{V,F(M)}} & V \triangleright' F(M) \\ {\scriptstyle F_{V,M}}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle F_{V,M}} \\ F(V \triangleright M) & \xrightarrow{F(e_{V,M})} & F(V \triangleright M) \end{array} \tag{2.7}$$

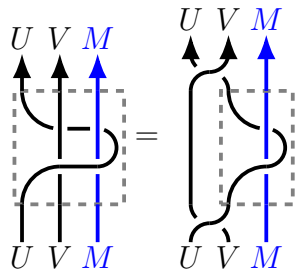
commutes for all $V \in \mathcal{C}$, $M \in \mathcal{M}$.

Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a braided $\mathcal{C}$-module category. We use the following graphical notation for the module braiding.

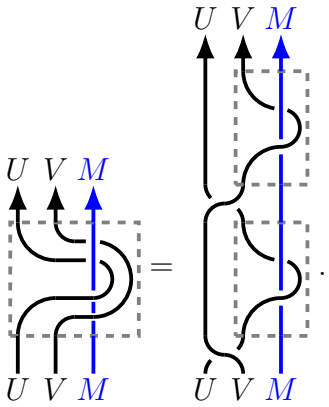
$e_{V,M} =$ 

(2.8)

The graphical notation for a braided module category implicitly uses the equivalence to a strict braided module category over a strict braided monoidal category. The conditions (2.6a) and (2.6b) are quite natural in the graphical notation,



(2.9a)



(2.9b)

2.2 Half-braided algebras and quantum moment maps

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an abelian braided monoidal category with right exact tensor product. In [JFR23] the theory of half-braided algebras, including the results of this section, was developed under the assumption that $\mathcal{C}$ is a fusion category. However, neither semisimplicity, rigidity, nor finiteness are required in the proofs of the statements we use. We include the proofs below as we refer to them in the sequel.

Proposition 2.8. [JFR23, Lemma 2.38] Let (A, m, u) be an algebra in $\mathcal{C}$. There is a bijective correspondence between module braidings for $\mathcal{C}_A$, and half-braidings

$\gamma^A : - \otimes A \Rightarrow A \otimes -$, depicted

$$\gamma_V^A = \quad , \tag{2.10}$$

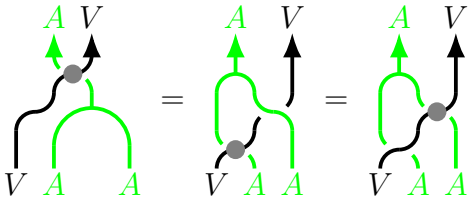


satisfying the hexagon [EGNO15, Eq. (7.41)], such that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 & & (A \otimes V) \otimes A & \xrightarrow{(A \otimes \sigma_{A,V}^{-1}) \circ \alpha} & A \otimes (A \otimes V) \\
 & \nearrow^{\gamma_V^A \otimes A} & & & \searrow^{(m \otimes V) \circ \alpha^{-1}} \\
(V \otimes A) \otimes A & & \xrightarrow{(V \otimes m) \circ \alpha} & V \otimes A \xrightarrow{\gamma_V^A} & A \otimes V \\
 & \searrow_{\sigma_{V,A} \otimes A} & & & \nearrow_{(m \otimes V) \circ \alpha^{-1}} \\
 & & (A \otimes V) \otimes A & \xrightarrow[(A \otimes \gamma_V^A) \circ \alpha]{} & A \otimes (A \otimes V)
\end{array} \tag{2.11}$$

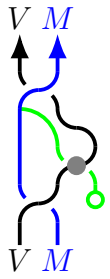
commutes for all objects V in $\mathcal{C}$. The condition (2.11) is depicted

$$= \quad = \tag{2.12}$$

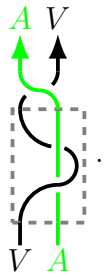


Proof. The proof is essentially identical to that of [JFR23, Lemma 2.38], although our convention differs from theirs. We reproduce it string-diagrammatically. We show via a direct computation that a module braiding can be obtained from a half-braiding via

$$e_{V,M} := \quad , \tag{2.13}$$

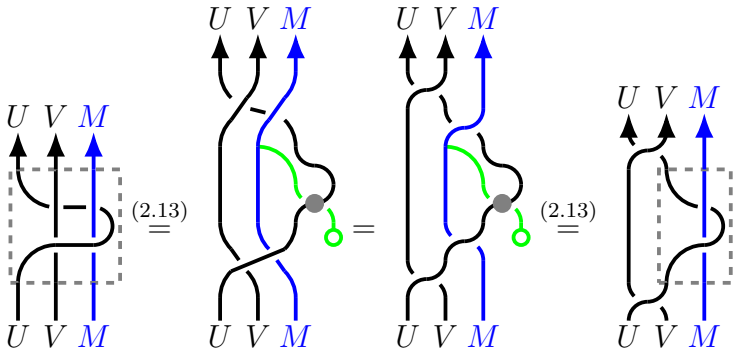


and a half-braiding from a module braiding via

$\gamma_V^A :=$ 

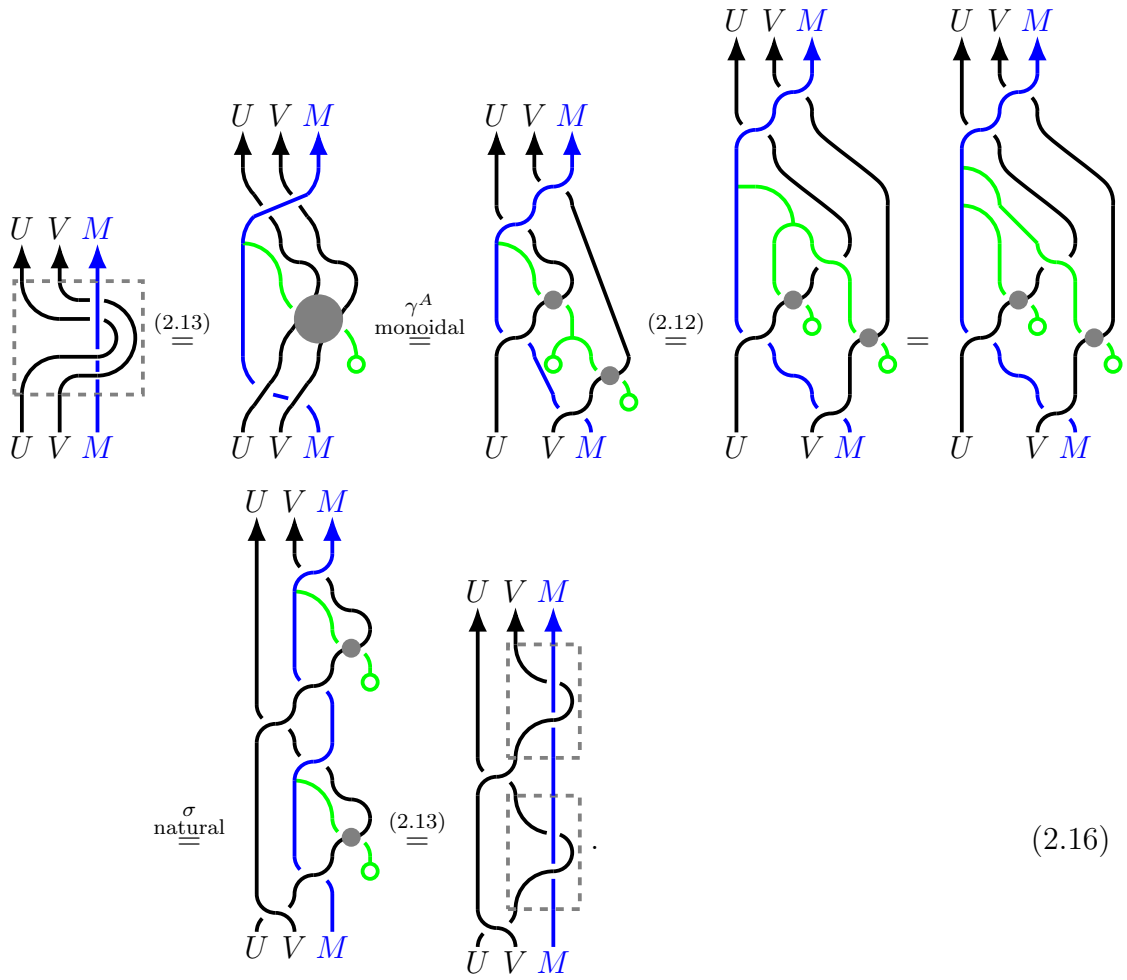
. (2.14)

Let U, V be objects in $\mathcal{C}$ and (M, ρ) an object in $\mathcal{C}_A$. Note that $V \triangleright M = (V \otimes M, V \otimes \rho)$ in the strict setting. First, we show that $e_{-,=}$ defined in (2.13) satisfies the condition (2.9a):



(2.15)

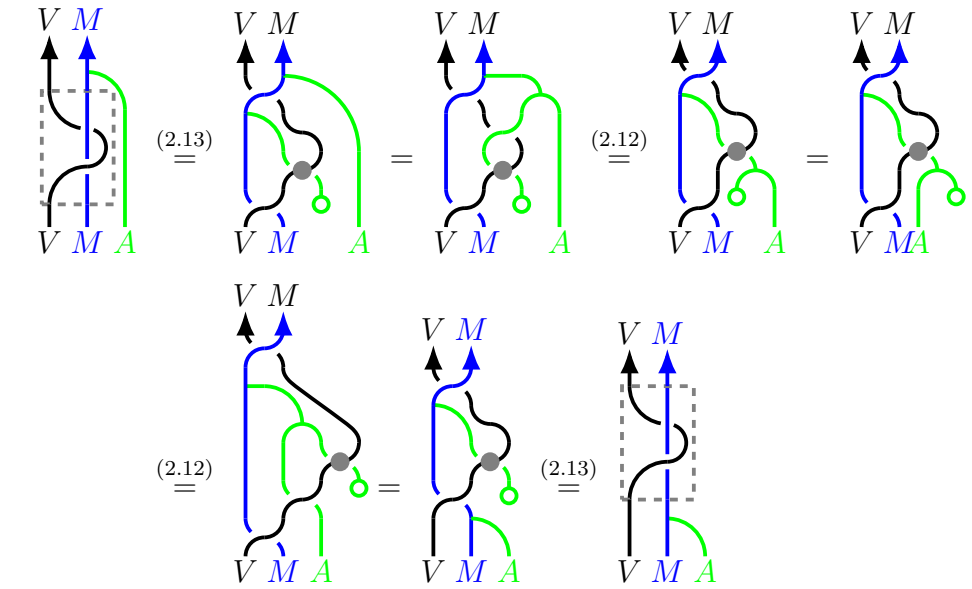
Now for the condition (2.9b):



(2.16)

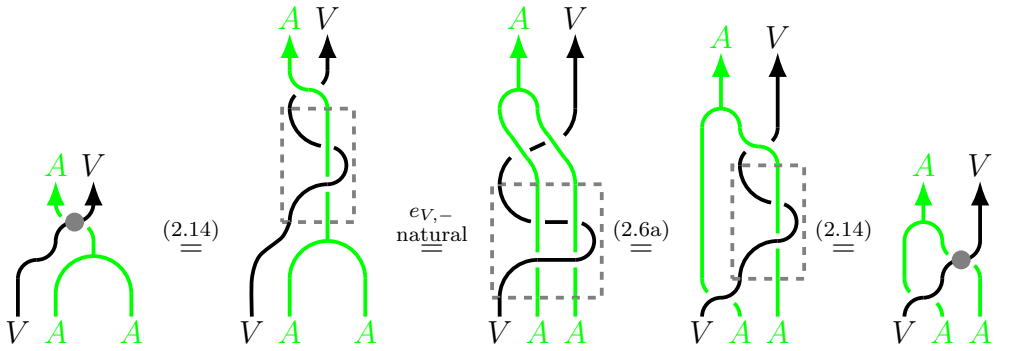
Finally, we show that each $e_{V,M}$ is a morphism in $\mathcal{C}_A$ (i.e. an intertwiner of A-

modules):

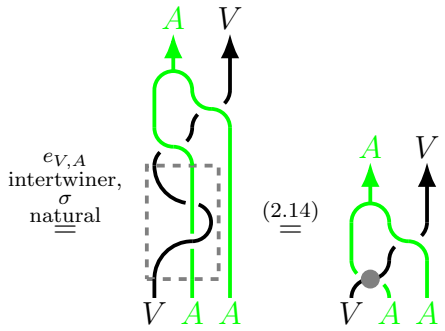


(2.17)

Now let us show that γ^A in (2.14) is a half-braiding.



(2.18)



(2.19)

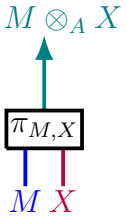
Showing that the assignments (2.13) and (2.14) are mutually inverse is a straight-

forward computation using the properties of half-braidings and module braidings. □

Definition 2.9. [JFR23, Def. 2.31] An algebra (A, m, u) in $\mathcal{C}$ equipped with a half-braiding γ^A satisfying (2.12) is called a *half-braided algebra*.

Remark 2.10. Setting $A = \mathbb{1}$ with the canonical (trivial) algebra we observe that a half-braiding for the regular $\mathcal{C}$-module category is equivalent to a monoidal natural automorphism of the identity functor, recovering [HS26, Prop. 2.2].

Let A and B be algebras in $\mathcal{C}$, M a right A-module in $\mathcal{C}$ and X an (A, B)-bimodule in $\mathcal{C}$. We depict the projector onto the relative tensor product $\pi_{M,X} : M \otimes X \to M \otimes_A X$ as

$\pi_{M,X} =$ 

(2.20)

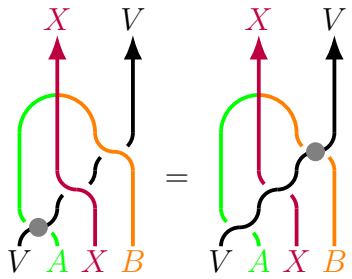
Proposition 2.11. [JFR23, Lem. 2.38] Let $((A, \gamma^A), m_A, u_A)$ and $((B, \gamma^B), m_B, u_B)$ be two half-braided algebras, and (X, ρ_A, ρ_B) be an (A, B)-bimodule in $\mathcal{C}$. The functor

$$- \otimes_A X : \mathcal{C}_A \to \mathcal{C}_B \tag{2.21}$$

is a braided module functor if and only if the diagram[1]

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
((V \otimes A) \otimes X) \otimes B & \xrightarrow{(\gamma^A_V \otimes X) \otimes B} & ((A \otimes V) \otimes X) \otimes B & \xrightarrow{A \otimes \sigma^{-1}_{X \otimes B, V}} & A \otimes ((X \otimes B) \otimes V) \\
\downarrow{\scriptstyle \sigma_{V, A \otimes X} \otimes B} & & & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle (\rho_A \circ \rho_B) \otimes V} \\
(A \otimes (X \otimes V)) \otimes B & \xrightarrow[A \otimes (X \otimes \gamma^B_V)]{} & A \otimes (X \otimes (B \otimes V)) & \xrightarrow[(\rho_A \circ \rho_B) \otimes V]{} & X \otimes V
\end{array} \tag{2.22}$$

commutes for all $V \in \mathcal{C}$. The condition (2.22) is depicted graphically as



(2.23)

.

[1] We have suppressed the coherence morphisms for brevity.

Proof. Right exactness of the tensor product ensures the functor $-\otimes_A X : \mathcal{C}_A \to \mathcal{C}_B$ is a $\mathcal{C}$-module functor [EGNO15, Prop. 7.11.1]. To be a braided module functor it needs to satisfy the condition (2.7). We show this by showing that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} V\otimes(M\otimes X) & \xrightarrow{V\otimes\pi_{M,X}} & V\otimes(M\otimes_A X) & \xrightarrow{e'_{V,(M\otimes_A X)}} & V\otimes(M\otimes_A X) \\ & & \sim\downarrow & & \downarrow\sim \\ & & (V\otimes M)\otimes_A X & \xrightarrow{e_{V,M}\otimes_A X} & (V\otimes M)\otimes_A X \end{array} \tag{2.24}$$

commutes for all $V \in \mathcal{C}$ and $M \in \mathcal{C}_A$. The $\mathcal{C}$-module functor structure, which is $\sim$ in (2.24), is the unique natural isomorphism $\phi_{-,=} : (-\otimes=)\otimes_A X \Rightarrow -\otimes(=\otimes_A X)$ such that

$$\begin{array}{ccc} V\otimes(M\otimes X) & \xrightarrow{V\otimes\pi_{M,X}} & V\otimes(M\otimes_A X) \\ \uparrow\alpha & & \phi_{V,M}\uparrow \\ (V\otimes M)\otimes X & \xrightarrow[\pi_{V\otimes M,X}]{} & (V\otimes M)\otimes_A X \end{array} \tag{2.25}$$

commutes. Hence (2.24) can be written,

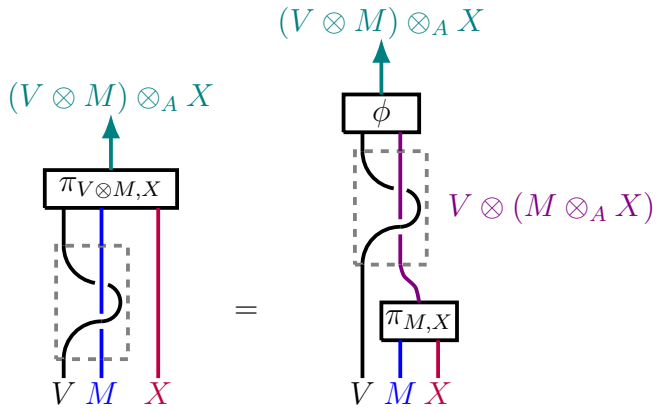
$$\begin{array}{ccccc} V\otimes(M\otimes X) & \xrightarrow{V\otimes\pi_{M,X}} & V\otimes(M\otimes_A X) & \xrightarrow{e'_{V,(M\otimes_A X)}} & V\otimes(M\otimes_A X) \\ \alpha^{-1}\downarrow & & \phi^{-1}_{V,M}\downarrow & & \downarrow\phi^{-1}_{V,M} \\ (V\otimes M)\otimes X & \xrightarrow[\pi_{V\otimes M,X}]{} & (V\otimes M)\otimes_A X & \xrightarrow{e_{V,M}\otimes_A X} & (V\otimes M)\otimes_A X \end{array} \tag{2.26}$$

where the left square commutes. Naturality of π implies (2.26) is equivalent to

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} V\otimes(M\otimes X) & \xrightarrow{V\otimes\pi_{M,X}} & V\otimes(M\otimes_A X) & \xrightarrow{e'_{V,(M\otimes_A X)}} & V\otimes(M\otimes_A X) \\ \alpha^{-1}\downarrow & & & \searrow^{\phi^{-1}_{V,M}} & \downarrow\phi^{-1}_{V,M} \\ (V\otimes M)\otimes X & \xrightarrow{e_{V,M}\otimes X} & (V\otimes M)\otimes X & \xrightarrow[\pi_{V\otimes M,X}]{} & (V\otimes M)\otimes_A X \end{array} \tag{2.27}$$

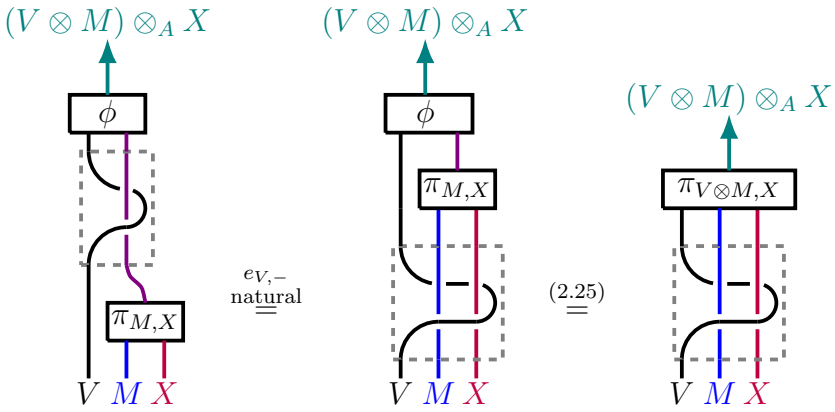
where the pentagon commutes. We now show that the outside rectangle of (2.27) commutes, which implies (2.24) commutes. The outside rectangle in (2.27) is

depicted



. (2.28)

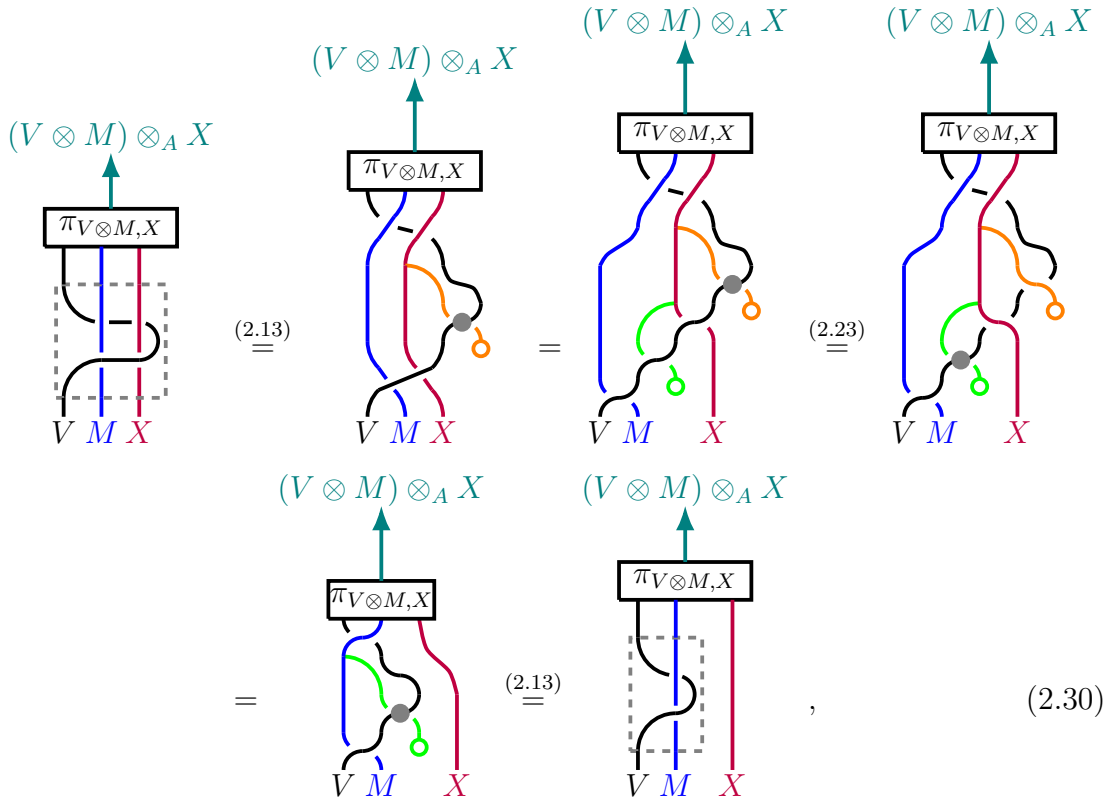
Using the fact that the module braiding is natural in each variable and $\pi_{M,X}$ is an intertwiner of right B-modules, we rewrite the right-hand side of (2.28) as



. (2.29)

We show that the left-hand side of (2.28) is equal to the right-hand side of (2.29)

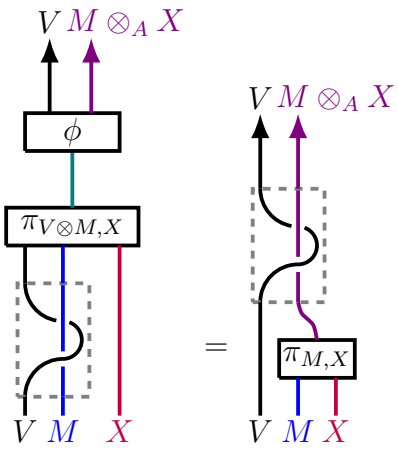
in the following string diagram computation.



(2.30)

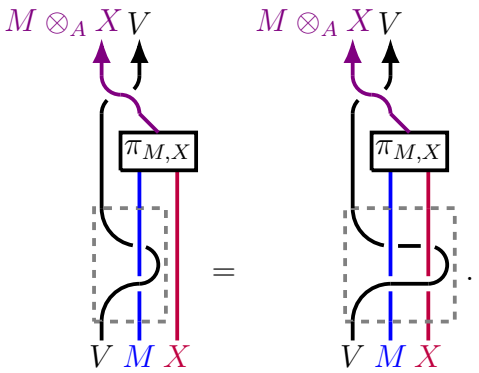
where in the second-last equality we used the presence of the projector onto $(V \otimes M) \otimes_A X$, and naturality of the braiding.

To prove the converse, note that $-\otimes_A N$ being a braided module functor implies



(2.31)

for all $M \in \mathcal{C}_A$. This in turn implies

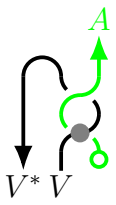


(2.32)

From this point, a similar computation as in the previous direction results in (2.22). □

In addition to being abelian and having a right exact tensor product, assume $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon. From a half-braiding for an algebra $A \in \mathcal{C}$ we obtain a dinatural transformation $j : (-)^* \otimes = : \ddot{\to} A$ as follows:

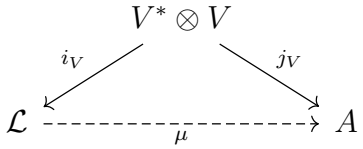
$$j_V := \quad \text{(2.33)}$$



The universal recipient of dinatural transformations is the coend of the functor $(-)^* \otimes = : \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{op}} \times \mathcal{C} \to \mathcal{C}$, and is denoted

$$\mathcal{L} = \int^{V \in \mathcal{C}} V^* \otimes V \,. \quad \text{(2.34)}$$

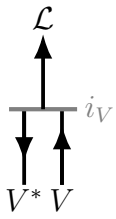
See [KL01, Ch. 5] for a detailed review of coends in braided monoidal categories. Assume $\mathcal{L}$ exists as an object in $\mathcal{C}$. By definition, it comes equipped with a dinatural transformation $i = (i_V : V^* \otimes V \to \mathcal{L})_{V \in \mathcal{C}}$ satisfying the following universal property: Given $A \in \mathcal{C}$ and dinatural transformation $j : (-)^* \otimes = : \ddot{\to} A$, there exists a unique morphism $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to A$ in $\mathcal{C}$ such that the diagram



(2.35)

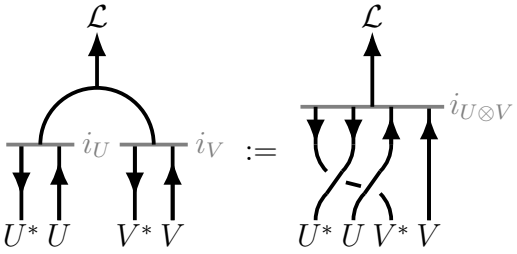
commutes for all V in $\mathcal{C}$. We depict the dinatural transformation i graphically as

$$i_V = \tag{2.36}$$

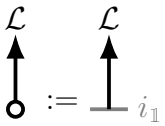


The morphisms $m : \mathcal{L} \otimes \mathcal{L} \to \mathcal{L}$ and $u : \mathbb{1} \to \mathcal{L}$ defined via

$$m \circ (i_U \otimes i_V) = \quad := \quad , \tag{2.37a}$$



$$u = \quad := \tag{2.37b}$$



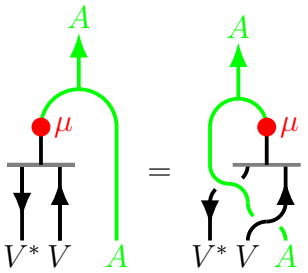
make $(\mathcal{L}, m, u)$ an algebra in $\mathcal{C}$.

Definition 2.12. Assume $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon and contains the coend $\mathcal{L}$. A *quantum moment map* is an algebra homomorphism $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to A$ in $\mathcal{C}$ such that

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} (V^* \otimes V) \otimes A & \xrightarrow{(\mu \circ i_V) \otimes A} & A \otimes A & \xrightarrow{\quad m \quad} & A \\ {\scriptstyle (V^* \otimes \sigma_{V,A}) \circ \alpha}\downarrow & & & & \uparrow{\scriptstyle m} \\ V^* \otimes (A \otimes V) & \xrightarrow[(\sigma^{-1}_{A,V^*} \otimes V) \circ \alpha^{-1}]{} & A \otimes (V^* V) & \xrightarrow[A \otimes (\mu \circ i_V)) \circ \alpha]{} & A \otimes A \end{array} \tag{2.38}$$

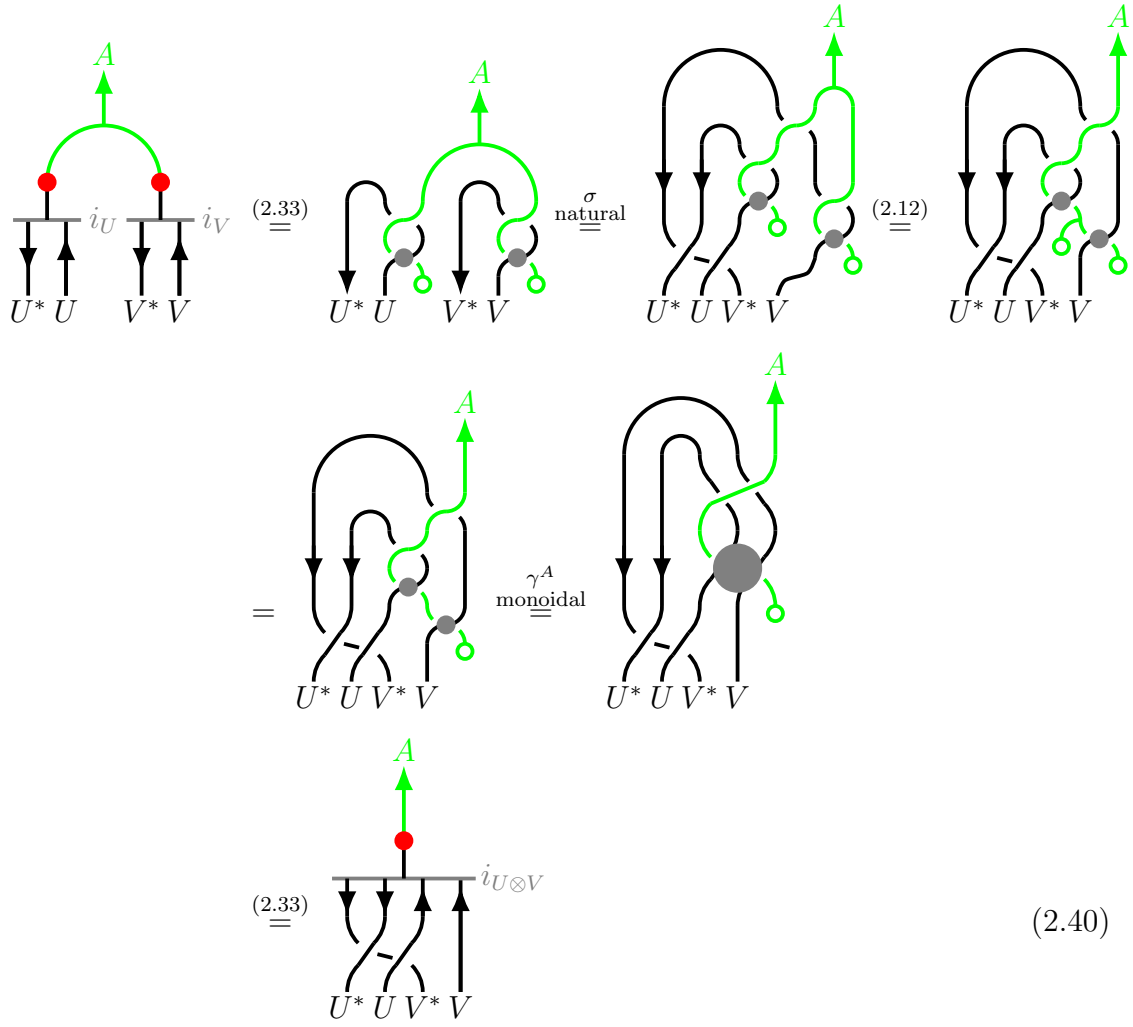
for all $V \in \mathcal{C}$. This condition is depicted

$$=$$ \tag{2.39}



Proposition 2.13. [JFR23, Sec. 2.5] Assume $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon and contains the coend $\mathcal{L}$. Given an algebra $A \in \mathcal{C}$, there is a bijective correspondence between half-braidings and quantum moment maps for A.

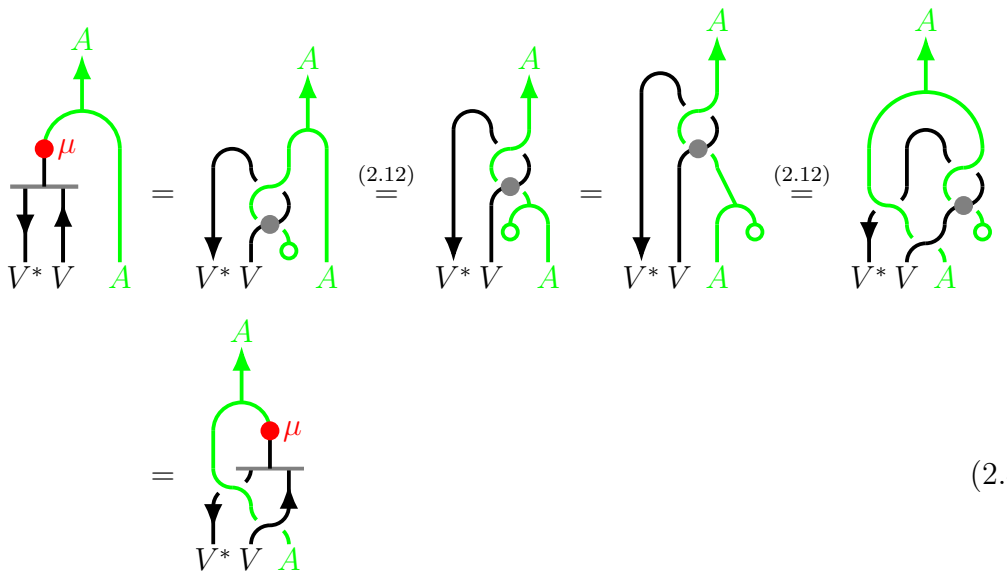
Proof. First we show that a half braiding can be used to construct a quantum moment map. From (2.33) we can construct a dinatural transformation from a half-braiding, and the universal property of the coend implies that there exists a unique morphism $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to A$. We now show that μ obtained this way is a quantum moment map. First, we show that it is an algebra homomorphism:



(2.40)

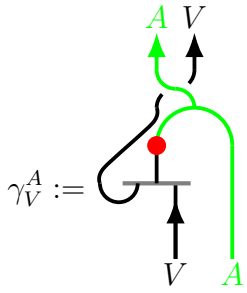
Preservation of the unit is clear from $\gamma^A_{\mathbb{1}} = \sigma_{A,\mathbb{1}} = \mathrm{id}_A$. Now we show that the

quantum moment map condition (2.39) is satisfied:



(2.41)

Now we consider the other direction. Given a quantum moment map $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to A$, we define a natural transformation $\gamma^A : - \otimes A \Rightarrow A \otimes -$ via

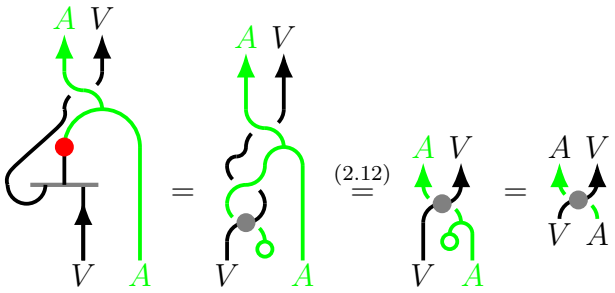


(2.42)

Dinaturality of $i : (-)^* \otimes = \ddot{\to} \mathcal{L}$ and naturality of the pivotal structure imply γ^A is natural. A straightforward string diagram computation shows that γ^A satisfies the conditions of a half braiding from Definition 2.8.

Finally, we show that these constructions are mutually inverse by inserting the quantum moment map obtained from the half-braiding (2.33) into (2.42), to obtain

the half-braiding back:



(2.43)

□

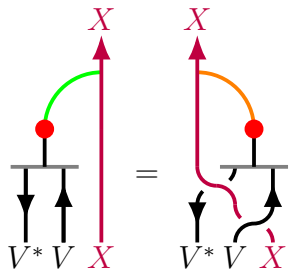
Proposition 2.14. Assume $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon and contains the coend $\mathcal{L}$. Let (A, m_A, u_A) and (B, m_B, u_B) be algebras in $\mathcal{C}$ with quantum moment maps μ_A and μ_B respectively, and let (X, ρ_A, ρ_B) be an (A, B)-bimodule in $\mathcal{C}$. The functor

$$- \otimes_A X : \mathcal{C}_A \to \mathcal{C}_B \tag{2.44}$$

is a braided module functor if and only if

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} (V^* \otimes V) \otimes N & \xrightarrow{\mu_A \circ i_V \otimes N} & A \otimes N & \xrightarrow{\quad\rho_A\quad} & N \\ {\scriptstyle (V^* \otimes \sigma_{V,N}) \circ \alpha}\downarrow & & & & \uparrow{\scriptstyle \rho_B} \\ V^* \otimes (N \otimes V) & \xrightarrow[(\sigma^{-1}_{N,V^*} \otimes V) \circ \alpha]{} & (N \otimes V^*) \otimes V & \xrightarrow[(N \otimes \mu_B \circ i_V) \circ \alpha]{} & N \otimes B \end{array} \tag{2.45}$$

This condition is depicted graphically as

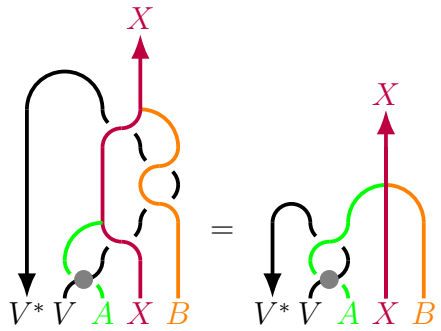


(2.46)

Proof. We show that the condition (2.23) implies the condition (2.46), which implies $- \otimes_A X$ is a braided $\mathcal{C}$-module functor. Proving the converse statement (that (2.46) implies (2.23)) is a similar computation, which we omit.

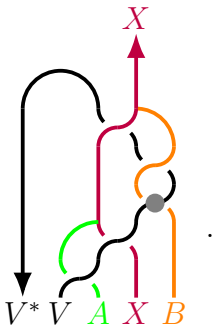
Invertibility of the braiding in $\mathcal{C}$ and the snake identities for the rigid structure

imply the left-hand side of (2.23) is equivalent to



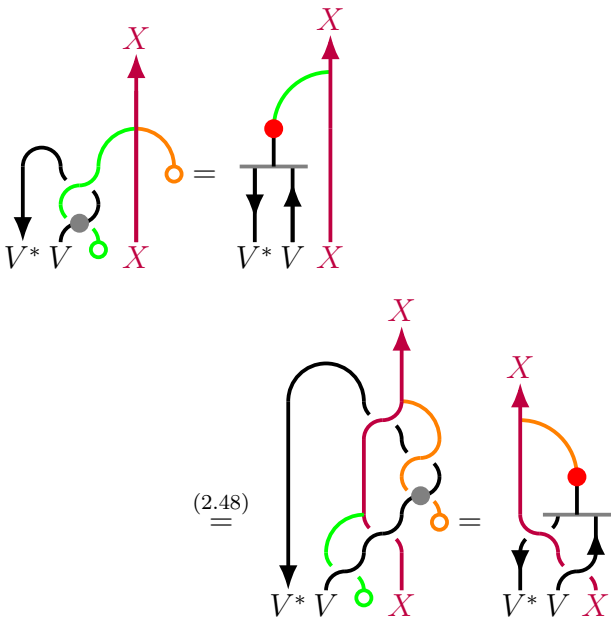
. (2.47)

Upon applying the same morphisms to the right-hand side of (2.23), we find



. (2.48)

Pre-composing with $V^* \otimes V \otimes u_A \otimes X \otimes u_B$ we obtain the identity (2.46):

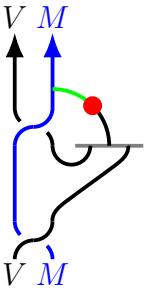


(2.49)

□

Combining Propositions 2.8 and 2.13, we arrive at the following result.

Corollary 2.15. [BZBJ18b, Cor. 4.11] Assume $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon and contains the coend $\mathcal{L}$. Let (A, m, u) be an algebra in $\mathcal{C}$. There is bijective correspondence between module braidings for $\mathcal{C}_A$ and quantum moment maps $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to A$. In this correspondence, a module braiding is constructed from a quantum moment map via

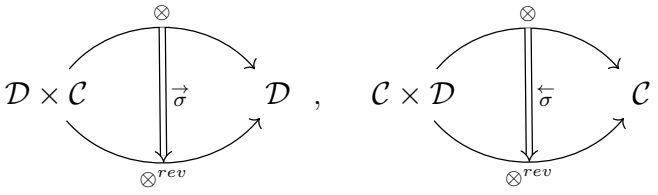
$e_{V,M} =$  . (2.50)

Remark 2.16. The pair (A, γ^A) is an object in the Drinfeld centre $Z(\mathcal{C})$ of $\mathcal{C}$. However, equipping the Drinfeld centre with the canonical monoidal structure which turns it into a braided monoidal category (see [EGNO15, Sec. 8.5]), the conditions (2.12) do not allow one to lift the algebra structure to an algebra structure in the Drinfeld centre. In [BZBJ18b, Cor. 4.6] (see also [JFR23, Def. 2.47]) it was observed that if $\mathcal{C}$ is ribbon, one can use the equivalence between $\mathcal{C}_{\mathcal{L}}$ and $Z(\mathcal{C})$ to define an alternative monoidal structure on $Z(\mathcal{C})$ such that a half-braided algebra in $\mathcal{C}$ lifts to an algebra in $Z(\mathcal{C})$. The category $\mathcal{C}_{\mathcal{L}}$ with this monoidal structure is sometimes called the *Harish-Chandra category* [GJS23, Sec. 2.5], see *loc. cit.* for details regarding its definition.

2.3 Small braidings

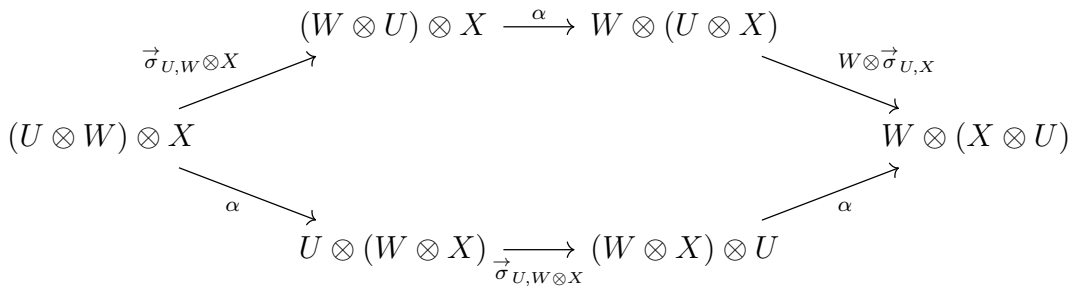
Let $(\mathcal{D}, \otimes, \mathbb{1}, \alpha, l, r)$ be a monoidal category, $\mathcal{C} \overset{\iota}{\hookrightarrow} \mathcal{D}$ a full monoidal subcategory, and $\otimes^{rev}$ the reversed tensor product: $U \otimes^{rev} V = V \otimes U$.

Definition 2.17. A *small braiding for* $\mathcal{C} \overset{\iota}{\hookrightarrow} \mathcal{D}$ is the data of two natural isomorphisms

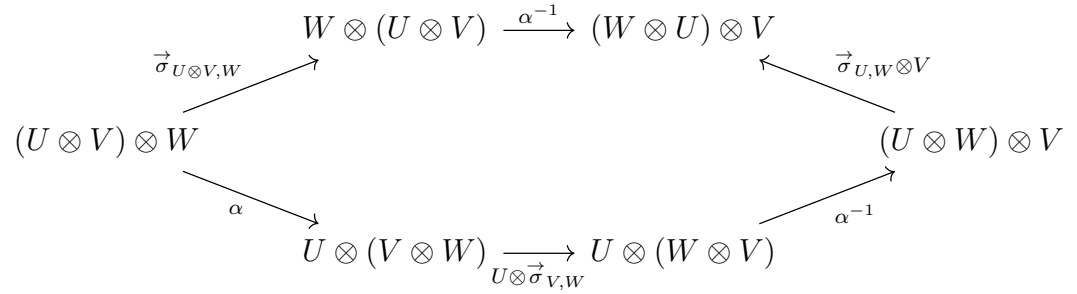


(2.51)

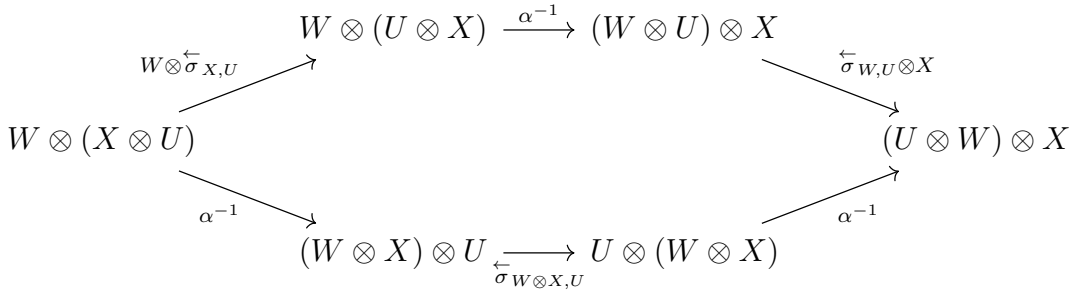
which satisfy the hexagon constraints,



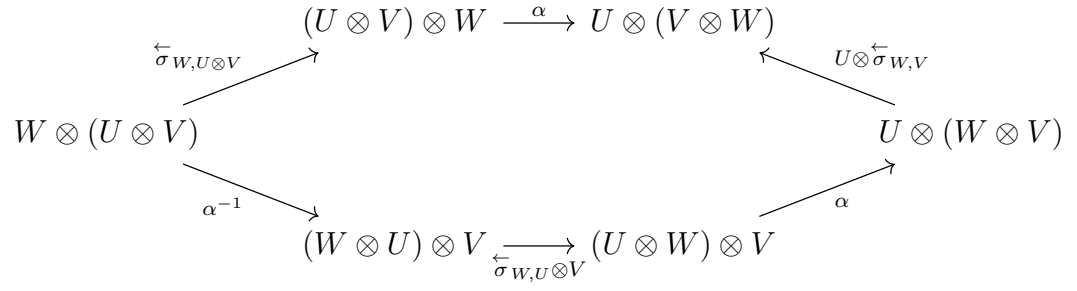
(2.52)



(2.53)



(2.54)



(2.55)

for all objects U, V in $\mathcal{D}$ and W, X in $\mathcal{C}$, and agree on $\mathcal{C}$. That is, for all objects U, V in $\mathcal{C}$, one has $\overrightarrow{\sigma}_{\iota U,V} = \overleftarrow{\sigma}_{U,\iota V}$.

We depict a small braiding similarly to a regular braiding by using a thicker

line to indicate the object which comes from $\mathcal{D}$:

$$\overrightarrow{\sigma}_{U,V} = \quad , \qquad \overleftarrow{\sigma}_{V,U} = \quad . \tag{2.56}$$



Lemma 2.18. A small braiding on $(\mathcal{C} \overset{\iota}{\hookrightarrow} \mathcal{D}, \overrightarrow{\sigma}, \overleftarrow{\sigma})$ endows $\mathcal{C}$ with the structure of a braided monoidal category, and $l_U \circ \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{U,\mathbb{1}} = r_U$ and $r_U \circ \overleftarrow{\sigma}_{\mathbb{1},U} = l_U$ for all $U \in \mathcal{D}$.

Proof. Since $\overrightarrow{\sigma}$ and $\overleftarrow{\sigma}$ agree on $\mathcal{C}$, their respective hexagons together define a braiding for $\mathcal{C}$. The unitality property $l_U \circ \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{U,\mathbb{1}} = r_U$ follows from setting $V = \mathbb{1}$ in (2.52) and inserting unitors in the interior as follows (c.f. [Ka95, Proposition XIII.1.2]):

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
 & & (\mathbb{1}\otimes U)\otimes W & \xrightarrow{\alpha} & \mathbb{1}\otimes(U\otimes W) & & \\
 & \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{U,\mathbb{1}}\otimes\mathrm{id}_W \nearrow & \downarrow{\scriptstyle l_U\otimes\mathrm{id}_W} & \swarrow{\scriptstyle l_{U\otimes W}} & & \searrow{\scriptstyle \mathbb{1}\otimes\overrightarrow{\sigma}_{U,W}} & \\
(U\otimes\mathbb{1})\otimes W & \xrightarrow[r_U\otimes\mathrm{id}_W]{} & U\otimes W & \xrightarrow[\overrightarrow{\sigma}_{U,W}]{} & W\otimes U & \xleftarrow[l_{W\otimes U}]{} & \mathbb{1}\otimes(W\otimes U) \\
 & \searrow{\scriptstyle \alpha} & \uparrow{\scriptstyle \mathrm{id}_U\otimes l_W} & & \uparrow{\scriptstyle l_W\otimes\mathrm{id}_U} & \nearrow{\scriptstyle \alpha} & \\
 & & U\otimes(\mathbb{1}\otimes W) & \xrightarrow[\overrightarrow{\sigma}_{U,\mathbb{1}\otimes W}]{} & (\mathbb{1}\otimes W)\otimes U & &
\end{array} \tag{2.57}$$

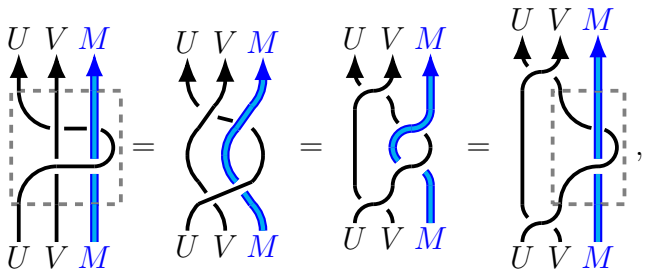
The square in the top half of the hexagon commutes via naturality of the unitor, and the square in the bottom half commutes from naturality of $\overrightarrow{\sigma}$. The two triangles adjacent to the top left triangle as well as the bottom right triangle commute from the definition of the unitor. Thus the top left triangle commutes, which gives us the result upon setting $W = \mathbb{1}$ and using the right unitor. The property $r_U \circ \overleftarrow{\sigma}_{\mathbb{1},U} = l_U$ can be proven by filling in the hexagon (2.54) similarly. □

In all sections that follow we denote with σ the underlying braiding in $\mathcal{C}$ coming from a small braiding $(\overrightarrow{\sigma}, \overleftarrow{\sigma})$ on $\mathcal{C} \overset{\iota}{\hookrightarrow} \mathcal{D}$. We also suppress coherence morphisms.

Proposition 2.19. Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a full subcategory of $\mathcal{D}$ such that $\iota V \otimes M$ is an object in $\mathcal{M}$ for all objects V in $\mathcal{C}$ and M in $\mathcal{M}$. Then $(\mathcal{M}, \overrightarrow{\sigma} \circ \overleftarrow{\sigma})$ is a braided left $\mathcal{C}$-module category with action functor $\iota \otimes -$.

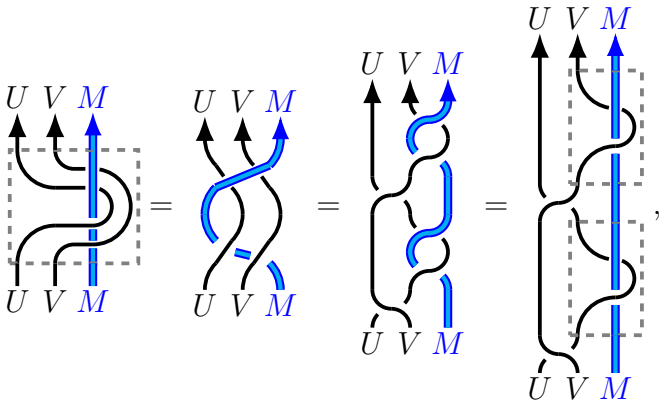
Proof. Let $\mathcal{M}$ be as above. The $\mathcal{C}$-module structure is given by the monoidal structure for $\mathcal{D}$. Let $U, V \in \mathcal{C}$ and $M \in \mathcal{M}$. The identities for $\overrightarrow{\sigma} \circ \overleftarrow{\sigma}$ we need to

verify are (2.6a) and (2.6b). The identity (2.6a) follows from



(2.58)

where in the first equality we inserted the definition of the module braiding $\overrightarrow{\sigma} \circ \overleftarrow{\sigma}$, and we used the hexagons in Definition 2.17 in the second equality. The identity (2.6b) follows from

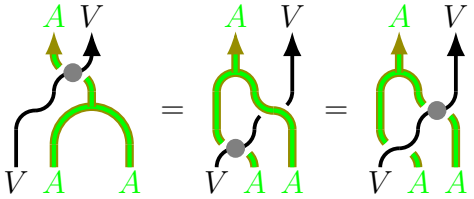


(2.59)

with the first equality being the definition of the module braiding and the second following from the hexagons and naturality of the small braidings □

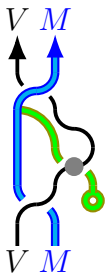
For the remainder of this section, assume $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ are abelian categories with right exact tensor product, and that $\iota : \mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}$ is right exact. Let (A, m, u) be an algebra in $\mathcal{D}$. By virtue of $\mathcal{C}$ being a monoidal subcategory of $\mathcal{D}$, the category $\mathcal{D}_A$ is a $\mathcal{C}$-module category. The following proposition adapts one direction of Proposition 2.8 in order to define a module braiding for $\mathcal{D}_A$ from a half-braiding for A. The proof is exactly the same as in Proposition 2.8.

Proposition 2.20. Let (A, m, u) be an algebra in $\mathcal{D}$. A half-braiding $\widehat{\gamma}^A : \iota \otimes A \Rightarrow A \otimes \iota$ satisfying

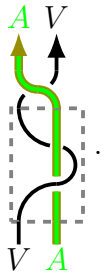


(2.60)

equips the $\mathcal{D}$-module category $\mathcal{D}_A$ with a module braiding given by

$e_{V,M} :=$  (2.61)

Remark 2.21. It is not clear to us if one can construct a half-braiding given a module braiding for $\mathcal{D}_A$: The inverse for the construction out of which one would wish to obtain a half-braiding is

$\widehat{\gamma}^A_V =$  . (2.62)

The first equality in (2.60) is implied from each $e_{V,A}$ being a morphism in $\mathcal{D}_A$ and the fact that the small braidings are natural. We do not know how to prove the second equality from the basic properties of module braidings. That being said, we do not have an example of a module braiding for $\mathcal{D}_A$ that does not give A a half-braiding.

As in the previous subsection, we call the pair consisting of an algebra $(A, m, u) \in \mathcal{D}$ and a half-braiding $\widehat{\gamma}^A$ satisfying (2.60) a half-braided algebra in $\mathcal{D}$.

Proposition 2.22. Upon replacing braidings with the appropriate half-braidings, Proposition 2.11 generalises to the case where A and B are half-braided algebras in $\mathcal{D}$.

Proof. Proving that the half-braided bimodule condition (2.23) is necessary and sufficient is done exactly as in Proposition 2.11. The only thing we require in addition is that for $A, B \in \mathcal{C}$, $M \in \mathcal{C}_A$ and X an (A, B)-bimodule in $\mathcal{C}$, the ιB-modules $\iota(M \otimes_A X)$ and $\iota M \otimes_{\iota A} \iota X$ should agree. Namely, we wish for ι to preserve coequalisers. This follows from our assumption that ι is right exact. □

Assume in addition to $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ being abelian and ι being right exact, that $\mathcal{C}$ is a ribbon category and that ι is left exact. Assume that the coend of the functor

$\iota((-)^* \otimes =) : \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{op}} \times \mathcal{C} \to \mathcal{D}$, denoted

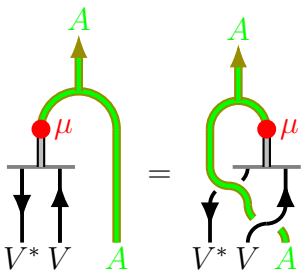
$$\mathcal{L} := \int^{V \in \mathcal{C}} \iota(V^* \otimes V) \,, \tag{2.63}$$

is contained in $\mathcal{D}$. In order to make sense of the algebra structure (2.37a),(2.37b) for $\mathcal{L}$ we require the Fubini theorem for coends,

$$\int^{V \in \mathcal{C}} \int^{U \in \mathcal{C}} \iota(U^* \otimes U) \otimes \iota(V^* \otimes V) \cong \int^{U \in \mathcal{C}} \int^{V \in \mathcal{C}} \iota(U^* \otimes U) \otimes \iota(V^* \otimes V) \,, \tag{2.64}$$

to hold. Since we ι assume is left exact, this follows from [Ly96, Thm. B.2]. As we did in Proposition 2.20, we obtain one direction of the results in Proposition 2.13 and Corollary 2.15.

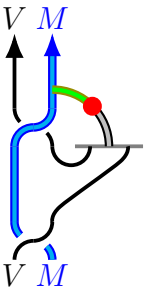
Proposition 2.23. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be ribbon, $\mathcal{D}$ contain the coend $\mathcal{L}$, and $\iota : \mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be exact. Let (A, m, u) be an algebra in $\mathcal{D}$. Let $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to A$ be an algebra homomorphism in $\mathcal{D}$ satisfying



(2.65)

for all $V \in \mathcal{C}$. The morphisms

$e_{V,M} =$



(2.66)

form a module braiding for $\mathcal{D}_A$.

Remark 2.24. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be ribbon, $\mathcal{D}$ contain the coend $\mathcal{L}$, and $\iota : \mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be exact. Upon replacing braidings with the appropriate small braidings, Proposition 2.14 holds for algebras $A, B \in \mathcal{D}$.

3 Braided module categories for quantum groups

In this section we construct examples of braided module categories and half-braided algebras/quantum moment maps coming from quantum groups. First we discuss small braidings associated to quantum groups at generic quantum parameter and introduce several concrete examples. We then change settings, and discuss small braidings coming from the $\hbar$-adic quantum group $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$. In the $\hbar$-adic setting we apply the machinery of Appendix A and the previous section to construct quantum moment maps from internal-hom algebras.

Throughout this section, fix a semisimple Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}$ of rank n. Let $\{\alpha_i\}$ be the simple roots of $\mathfrak{g}$, $\{H_i\}$ the simple coroots and P the weight lattice. Let $(-,=)$ be the standard symmetric bilinear form on $\mathfrak{h}^*$ defined via the Killing form on $\mathfrak{g}$, and $d_i = (\alpha_i, \alpha_i)$.

3.1 Small braidings from unrolled quantum groups

We work over $\mathbb{C}$ and with quantum parameter $q \in \mathbb{C}^\times$, for which we fix a logarithm. We say q is *generic* if it is not a root of unity, so $\log q \in \mathbb{C} \setminus \mathbb{Q}\pi\sqrt{-1}$. We denote $e^{a \log q}$ by q^a for $a \in \mathbb{C}$, and for any operator A denote $e^{\log q A}$ by q^A. We denote with $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ the unrolled quantum group based on $\mathfrak{g}$, which was originally defined for $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sl}_2$ in [GPT07] and for an arbitrary semisimple Lie algebra in [GP10]. We use the definition of $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ from [Ru19, Def. 3.1], which allows for generic quantum parameter, and recall a few basic facts and notation in what follows. Denote $U_q\mathfrak{h}$, $U_q\mathfrak{n}_+$ and $U_q\mathfrak{n}_-$ the subalgebras of $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ generated by $\{K_i^{\pm 1}\}_{i=1}^n$, $\{E_i\}_{i=1}^n$ and $\{F_i\}_{i=1}^n$, respectively, and denote the generators of $U\mathfrak{h}$ with $\{H_i\}_{i=1}^n$. The translation between the notation of [Ru19] and our notation is $K_i = K_i$, $K_{-i} = K_i^{-1}$, $X_i = E_i$ and $X_{-i} = F_i$. The generators coming from $U_q\mathfrak{n}_\pm$ act nilpotnently in finite-dimensional representations. Let $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ be the subalgebra of $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ generated by $U_q\mathfrak{h}$ and $U_q\mathfrak{n}_\pm$, which is exactly the $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ defined in [KS97, Sec. 6.1.2].

Recall that a $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-module V is a *weight module* if there exist vectors $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$ such that V decomposes as [GP10, Sec. 5.3]

$$V \cong \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*} V_\lambda \ , \quad V_\lambda = \{v : H_i \cdot v = \lambda(H_i)v \ , \quad K_i \cdot v = q^{H_i} \cdot v\} \ , \tag{3.1}$$

Let $\mathcal{D}^H$ be the full monoidal subcategory of $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-modules consisting of weight modules, and $\mathcal{C}^H$ the full monoidal subcategory of $\mathcal{D}^H$ consisting of finite-dimensional modules.

The braiding for $\mathcal{C}^H$ is not implemented by the truncated R-matrices of [GP10, Ru19], as these only work when q is a root of unity and one restricts to a certain subcategory of $\mathcal{C}^H$ (or considers modules over the restricted quantum group). To

define the R-matrix for $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ at generic quantum parameter we note that the braiding of finite-dimensional $U_q\mathfrak{g}$ modules defined per [KS97, Prop. 8.19] can be used to define a braiding for finite-dimensional $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-modules. Indeed, taking the R-matrix from [KS97, Thm. 8.18] and noting that $R\Delta(H_i) = \Delta^{\mathrm{op}}(H_i)R$, all that we need to prove is that the endomorphism $u \otimes v \mapsto q^{(\lambda,\mu)}u \otimes v$, for $u \in U_\lambda$ and $v \in V_\mu$ where U and V are weight modules, can be made well-defined for arbitrary $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-weight modules. Using the duality between $\mathfrak{h}$ and $\mathfrak{h}^*$, we define

$$u \otimes v \mapsto q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i(A^{-1})_{ij}H_i\otimes H_j} \cdot u \otimes v \ . \tag{3.2}$$

It follows from [GP10, Lem. 40] that this coincides with the desired endomorphism of [KS97, Prop. 8.19].

The obstruction to braiding $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-modules of arbitrary dimension is that the R-matrix of [KS97, Thm. 8.18] contains infinite sums over powers of $U_q\mathfrak{n}_\pm$ generators. This sum will not truncate when the R-matrix acts on a tensor product of modules which are not locally finite as $U_q\mathfrak{n}_+$- or $U_q\mathfrak{n}_-$-modules. The torsion-free modules of [FHW15] are an example of such modules. However, the sum will truncate if at least one of the modules is finite-dimensional, so one can braid a finite-dimensional module with an infinite-dimensional module. We then arrive at our first example of a small braiding:

Proposition 3.1. For all $U, V \in \mathcal{D}^H$ define $s_{U,V}$ to be the swap operation on tensor products of vector spaces: $s_{U,V}(u \otimes v) := v \otimes u$ for all $u \in U$ and $v \in V$. If q is generic, then the morphisms

$$\overrightarrow{\sigma}_{U,V}(u \otimes v) = s_{U,V}q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i(A^{-1})_{ij}H_i\otimes H_j}R \cdot (u \otimes v) \tag{3.3a}$$

$$\overleftarrow{\sigma}_{V,U}(v \otimes u) = s_{V,U}q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i(A^{-1})_{ij}H_i\otimes H_j}R \cdot (v \otimes u) \ , \tag{3.3b}$$

where R is the R-matrix for $U_q\mathfrak{g}$, defines a small braiding on $\mathcal{C}^H \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}^H$.

For applications in skein theory, we are interested in defining a small braiding for the category of so-called finite-dimensional type 1 modules for $U_q\mathfrak{g}$. Recall that a $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-module is of type 1 if there exist $\lambda \in P$ such that [CP95, pp. 314] (see also [Ch94, pp. 4])

$$V \cong \bigoplus_{\lambda\in P} V_\lambda \ , \quad V_\lambda = \{v : K_i \cdot v = q^{\lambda(H_i)}v\} \ . \tag{3.4}$$

The following proposition allows us to define a small braiding between finite-dimensional $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-modules of type 1 and $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-weight modules.

Proposition 3.2. . Let q be generic and $\mathcal{C}$ be the category of finite-dimensional $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-modules of type 1. $\mathcal{C}$ is a full monoidal subcategory of $\mathcal{C}^H$.

Proof. If q is generic the decomposition (3.4) of $V \in \mathcal{C}$ is unique as each $\lambda(H_i) \in \mathbb{Z}$ when $\lambda \in P$. Define the functor $\iota : \mathcal{C} \to \mathcal{C}^H$ to leave the underlying vector spaces of the objects and linear maps of the morphisms the same, and define an action of the generators of $U\mathfrak{h}$ to be $H_i \cdot v = \lambda(H_i)v$ for $v \in V_\lambda$. The uniqueness of the decomposition (3.4) implies that linear maps which intertwine the $U_q\mathfrak{h}$ generators also intertwine the generators of $U\mathfrak{h}$, so ι is a well-defined functor. Furthermore the uniqueness of the decomposition implies such maps are in bijection, so ι is fully faithful. Let us now show ι is monoidal. Let $u \in U_\mu$ and $v \in V_\lambda$ for $U, V \in \mathcal{C}$. Consider $u \otimes v \in (U \otimes V)_{\mu+\lambda}$, on which the action of $K_i \in U_q\mathfrak{h}$ is given by

$$K_i \cdot (u \otimes v) = q^{\mu(H_i)+\lambda(H_i)} u \otimes v = q^{(\mu+\lambda)(H_i)} u \otimes v \ . \tag{3.5}$$

The action of $H_i \in U\mathfrak{h}$ on $u \otimes v$ is

$$H_i \cdot (u \otimes v) = H_i \cdot u \otimes v + u \otimes H_i \cdot v = (\mu + \lambda)(H_i) u \otimes v \ , \tag{3.6}$$

as desired. □

Let q, $\mathcal{C}^H$, $\mathcal{C}$ and $\iota : \mathcal{C} \to \mathcal{C}^H$ be as in Proposition 3.2. The composition $\mathcal{C} \overset{\iota}{\hookrightarrow} \mathcal{C}^H \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}^H$ is then a monoidal inclusion, which furthermore preserves the small braiding.

Theorem 3.3. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be the category of finite-dimensional $U_q\mathfrak{g}$-modules of type 1, $\mathcal{D}^H$ be the category $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-weight modules, and $\mathcal{C}^H$ the full subcategory of $\mathcal{D}^H$ of finite-dimensional modules. For generic quantum parameter q, there is a small braiding on the monoidal inclusion $\mathcal{C} \overset{\iota}{\hookrightarrow} \mathcal{C}^H \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}^H$ given by

$$\overrightarrow{\sigma}_{U,V}(u \otimes v) = s_{U,V} q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i (A^{-1})_{ij} H_i \otimes H_j} R \cdot (u \otimes v) \tag{3.7a}$$

$$\overleftarrow{\sigma}_{V,U}(v \otimes u) = s_{V,U} q^{\sum_{i,j=1}^n d_i (A^{-1})_{ij} H_i \otimes H_j} R \cdot (v \otimes u) \ , \tag{3.7b}$$

where R is the R-matrix for $U_q\mathfrak{g}$.

3.2 Examples for generic quantum parameter

We now study subcategories of $\mathcal{D}^H$ closed under tensoring with objects in $\mathcal{C}$ in order to construct examples of braided module categories and quantum moment maps from the small braiding on $\mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}^H$. Given a weight module M we denote with M_μ the weight μ subspace of M. We refer the reader to [KS97, Sec. 6.2.5 & Ch. 7.1] for background on the representation theory of $U_q\mathfrak{g}$.

In the examples that follow, the module braiding is given by the monodromy $\overrightarrow{\sigma} \circ \overleftarrow{\sigma}$, as per the perscription in Lemma 2.19. We understand the following example to be folklore that is not written down anywhere or obtainable through any known systematic construction of braided module categories. It can be viewed as an unrolled version of the quantum category $\mathcal{O}$ of [AM14].

Example 3.4. Define $\mathcal{O}_q^H$ to be the full subcategory of $\mathcal{D}^H$ consisting of modules which are finitely generated and in which $U_q^H\mathfrak{n}_+$ acts nilpotently. $\mathcal{O}_q^H$ is closed under tensoring with $\mathcal{C}$ and thus a braided $\mathcal{C}$-module category.

For each pair $\lambda, \mu \in \mathfrak{h}^*$, say $\lambda \sim \mu$ if $\lambda - \mu$ is integral. Let $W \in \mathcal{C}$ and $V \in \mathcal{D}^H$. Because the weight support of W is integral, given a weight λ in the support of V, any weight μ in the support of $W \otimes V$ is such that $\mu \sim \lambda$. We then arrive at the following example of a subcategory of $\mathcal{D}^H$ closed under tensoring with objects in $\mathcal{C}$.

Example 3.5. For each $\Lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*/\sim$, the full subcategory $\mathcal{D}_\Lambda^H$ of $\mathcal{D}^H$ consisting of modules with weight support in Λ is closed under tensoring with objects in $\mathcal{C}$ and thus a braided $\mathcal{C}$-module category.

Let $[0] \in \mathfrak{h}^*/\sim$ be the class containing integral weights. Weights which are not in $[0]$ are referred to as generic. Recall that as in the classical case, a Verma module is irreducible if its highest weight is not dominant integral [ES00, Prop. 2.1]. Using this, we define module subcategories of $\mathcal{D}_\Lambda^H$ which contain only direct sums of irreducible Verma modules. First we show how the tensor product of an irreducible Verma module with a finite-dimensional module decomposes as a direct sum of irreducible modules.

Proposition 3.6. Let $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$ be generic and $V(\lambda)$ be a Verma module for $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$. The tensor product $W \otimes V(\lambda)$ decomposes as

$$W \otimes V(\lambda) \cong \bigoplus_{\mu \in \mathfrak{h}^*} V(\lambda+\mu)^{\oplus \dim(W_\mu)} \,. \tag{3.8}$$

for all finite-dimensional weight modules W.

Proof. Given $\lambda, \mu \in \mathfrak{h}^*$ we denote with $v_\lambda \in V(\lambda)$ the highest weight vector. Recall that for $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$ generic, there is for every $w \in W_\mu$ a unique intertwiner $\Phi_{\lambda+\mu}^w : V(\lambda+\mu) \to W \otimes V(\lambda)$ such that [ES00, Prop. 2.2]

$$\Phi_{\lambda+\mu}^w(v_{\lambda+\mu}) = w \otimes v_\lambda + u \,, \tag{3.9}$$

where $u \in \bigoplus_{\nu<\lambda} W \otimes V(\lambda)_\nu$. See *loc. cit.* for a proof of this fact. These intertwiners assemble into an intertwiner [Ko00, Eq. 6.10]

$$\eta_W^\lambda : \bigoplus_{\mu \in \mathfrak{h}^*} W_\mu \otimes V(\lambda+\mu) \cong \bigoplus_{\mu \in \mathfrak{h}^*} V(\lambda+\mu)^{\oplus \dim(W_\mu)} \to W \otimes V(\lambda) \,, \tag{3.10}$$

defined via $\eta_W^\lambda(w \otimes v) = \Phi_{\lambda+\mu}^w(v)$, where the action of $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ on $W_\mu \otimes V(\lambda+\mu)$ is given by

$$x \cdot (w \otimes v) = w \otimes (x \cdot v) \,. \tag{3.11}$$

for all $x \in U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$ and $w \otimes v \in W_\mu \otimes V(\lambda+\mu)$. It remains to show that η_W^λ is an isomorphism.

We begin with injectivity of η_W^λ. Since each $V(\lambda+\mu)$ is irreducible and each $\Phi^w_{\lambda+\mu}$ for $w \neq 0$ is non-zero when applied to the highest weight vector, the maps $\Phi^w_{\lambda+\mu}$ are injective. Furthermore, the maps

$$W_\mu \to W \otimes V(\lambda)\ , \quad w \mapsto \Phi^w_{\lambda+\mu}(v_{\lambda+\mu}) \tag{3.12}$$

is also injective. Thus η_W^λ is injective.

Now we show η_W^λ is surjective. The restriction of η_W^λ to each weight space is also an injective map. Because the weight spaces of the left- and right-hand side of (3.8) are finite-dimensional, if they have equal dimension, η_W^λ is surjective. We see this as follows:

$$\begin{aligned}\dim(W \otimes V(\lambda))_\eta &= \sum_\mu \dim(W_\mu)\dim(V(\lambda)_{\eta-\mu}) \\ &= \sum_\mu \dim(W_\mu)\dim(V(\lambda+\mu)_\eta) \\ &= \dim\left(\bigoplus_\mu W_\mu \otimes V(\lambda+\mu)\right)_\eta\ ,\end{aligned} \tag{3.13}$$

where the second line follows from comparing bases of $V(\lambda)_{\eta-\mu}$ and $V(\lambda+\mu)_\eta$, which we do now. $V(\lambda)_{\eta-\mu}$ has a basis

$$B = \left\{ F_1^{k_1}\cdots F_n^{k_n}\cdot v_\lambda \ :\ \sum_{i=1}^n k_i\alpha_i = \lambda - (\eta-\mu) \right\} \tag{3.14}$$

and $V(\lambda+\mu)_\eta$ has a basis

$$B' = \left\{ F_1^{k_1}\cdots F_n^{k_n}\cdot v_{\lambda+\mu} \ :\ \sum_{i=1}^n k_i\alpha_i = \lambda+\mu-\eta \right\}\ . \tag{3.15}$$

Hence $|B| = |B'|$, as desired. □

Note that μ will be an integral weight, because W is finite dimensional. Hence to guarantee that each $V(\lambda+\mu)$ is irreducible, λ must be generic. Now we can define an example containing only direct sums of irreducible Verma modules.

Example 3.7. For each $\Lambda \in (\mathfrak{h}^*/\sim) \setminus [0]$ the full subcategory $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda^H$ of $\mathcal{D}_\Lambda^H$ of modules that are isomorphic to a finite direct sum of Verma modules of highest weight $\lambda \in \Lambda$ is closed under tensoring with $\mathcal{C}$, and thus a braided $\mathcal{C}$-module category.

In the case $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sl}_2$, facets of the categories $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda^H$ have appeared in the literature before. Fix the pivotal structure for $\mathcal{C}$ which recovers the Kauffman bracket skein relations (see [Ti10] for more details) and let V be the fundamental representation of $U_q\mathfrak{sl}_2$. In this setting the Temperley-Lieb algebra on n strands is isomorphic to the endomorphism space of $V^{\otimes n} \in \mathcal{C}$. Furthermore, the hom-space from n to m in the Temperley-Lieb category is isomorphic to $\mathcal{C}(V^{\otimes m}, V^{\otimes n})$, and the Karoubi completion of the Temperley-Lieb category is $\mathcal{C}$. From the results of [ILZ19], the blob algebra of [MS94] on n strands is isomorphic to the endomorphism algebra of $V^{\otimes n} \triangleright V(\lambda)$ in $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda^H$. In fact, the hom-spaces of the blob category defined in [LNV21, Sec. 2.2] are given by hom-spaces of $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda^H$. We also deduce from this observation that the blob category is a braided module category over the Temperley-Lieb category. See also [CGS22] for the relation between endomorphism spaces of $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda^H$, the blob algebra, and boundary conditions of the XXZ spin chain.

3.3 Quantum moment maps from internal-homs

We now construct examples of quantum moment maps, namely those which recover the quantisations of [Mu07]. In order to do this we change settings and work with the $\hbar$-adic Hopf algebra $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ over $\mathbb{C}[[\hbar]]$, see [KS97, Sec. 6.1.3] for details regarding the definition. First we introduce some terminology which will let us define categories of $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules from which we can obtain quantum moment maps via small braidings. Let W be a complex vector space. Define $W[[\hbar]]$ to be the $\mathbb{C}[[\hbar]]$-module containing all formal series $\sum_{n\geq 0} v_n\hbar^n$, where $(v_0, v_1, \dots)$ is a sequence of elements in V (see [Ka95, Eq. (XVI.1.2)] for the $\mathbb{C}[[\hbar]]$-module structure). A $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-module V is called *topologically-free* if it is isomorphic as a $\mathbb{C}[[\hbar]]$-module to $W[[\hbar]]$, where W is a $U\mathfrak{g}$-module over $\mathbb{C}$ [Ka95, Sec. XVI.2]. The *completed tensor product* of $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules, $\widehat{\otimes}$, is the $\hbar$-adic completion of $\otimes_{\mathbb{C}[[\hbar]]}$, see [Ka95, Def. XVI.3.1]. For topologically-free modules $X[[\hbar]]$ and $Y[[\hbar]]$ one has $X[[\hbar]]\widehat{\otimes}Y[[\hbar]] \cong (X \otimes Y)[[\hbar]]$ as $\mathbb{C}[[\hbar]]$-modules, so topologically-free modules form a monoidal subcategory of $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules [Ka95, Prop. XVI.3.2]. The Hopf algbra $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ is itself topologically-free, and isomorphic to $U\mathfrak{g}[[\hbar]]$ as an algebra [Ka95, Thm. XVIII.4.1].

The Hopf algebra $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ is a quasitriangular $\hbar$-adic Hopf algebra [KS97, Thm 8.17], meaning the R-matrix $\mathcal{R} = \mathcal{R}_1\widehat{\otimes}\mathcal{R}_2$ for $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ is an element of $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}\widehat{\otimes}U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$. Hence acting with $\mathcal{R}$ is well-defined on any tensor product of topologically-free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules, not just the finite-dimensional ones. We then have that the category of topologically-free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules is a braided monoidal category. From [Ka95, Exercise XVI.2] we also see that the category of topologically-free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules is closed, with the internal-hom objects $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V)$ being given by $\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}[[\hbar]]}(U, V)$. The action of $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ on $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V)$ is

$$(x \cdot f)(-) = x_{(1)}f(S(x_{(2)}) \cdot -) \tag{3.16}$$

for all $x \in U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ and $f \in \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,V)$.

Now we fix our setting: Let $\mathcal{C}$ be the category of finite-dimensional topologically-free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules and $\mathcal{D}$ be the category of all topologically-free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules. When we write the tensor product $\otimes$ we always mean $\widehat{\otimes}$. The small braiding on $\mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}$ is simply given by the braiding on $\mathcal{D}$. We indicate successive applications of $\mathcal{R}$ with a prime superscript. For example, the monodromy $\overrightarrow{\sigma} \circ \overleftarrow{\sigma}$ is given by

$$\overrightarrow{\sigma}_{V,U} \circ \overleftarrow{\sigma}_{U,V}(u \otimes v) = \mathcal{R}'_2\mathcal{R}_1 u \otimes \mathcal{R}'_1\mathcal{R}_2 v \ , \tag{3.17}$$

for all $U \in \mathcal{C}$, $V \in \mathcal{D}$ and $u \in U$, $v \in V$.

Fix a full subcategory $\mathcal{M} \subset \mathcal{D}$ which is closed under tensoring with objects in $\mathcal{C}$. We also use the fact that $\mathcal{D}$ is a closed category and $\mathcal{C}$ is rigid, which allows us to apply the results of Appendix A. Denote by $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$ the internal endomorphism algebra $(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,V), m^V_{V,V}, u_V)$ of Corollary A.4.

Proposition 3.8. For all $V \in \mathcal{D}$, the natural isomorphism $\gamma^{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}_- : - \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \Rightarrow \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \otimes -$ defined via

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} U \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) & & \xrightarrow{\quad\Phi_{U,V}\quad} & & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, U \otimes V) \\ \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \gamma^{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}_U} & & & & \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{V,U}\overleftarrow{\sigma}_{U,V})} \\ \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \otimes U & \xleftarrow[\overrightarrow{\sigma}^{-1}_{U,\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}]{} & U \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) & \xleftarrow[\Phi^{-1}_{U,V}]{} & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, U \otimes V) \end{array} \tag{3.18}$$

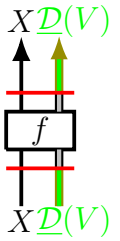
is a half-braiding for $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$. Let $M \in \mathcal{M}$ and consider $\mathcal{M}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}$ as braided module categories, with module braiding coming from the small braiding and half-braiding respectively. The functor $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,-) : \mathcal{M} \to \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}$ is a braided $\mathcal{C}$-module functor.

Proof. Naturality of the half-braiding follows from naturality of the coherence morphisms and the small braidings. It remains to show that the diagram (2.60) commutes.

Let $X, Y \in \mathcal{C}$. Conjugating the image of a morphism $f : X \otimes V \to Y \otimes V$ under $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,-)$ with the $\mathcal{C}$-module functor structure Φ for $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,-)$ defines a morphism

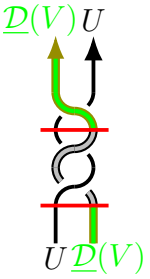
$$\underline{f} := \Phi_{Y,V}\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,f)\Phi^{-1}_{X,V} : X \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \to Y \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \ . \tag{3.19}$$

We depict this as follows.

$\underline{f} =$ 

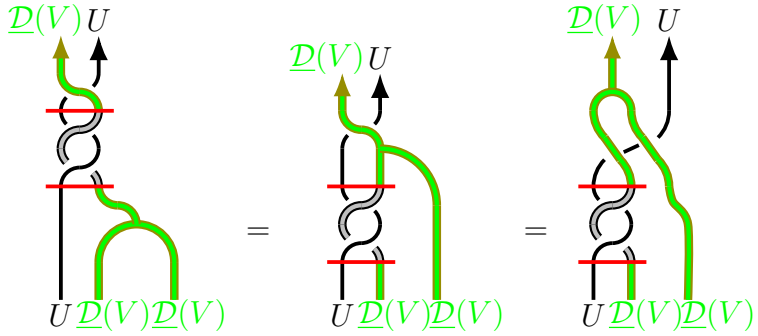
(3.20)

The candidate (3.18) for the half-braiding is then depicted

$\gamma_U^{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)} =$ 

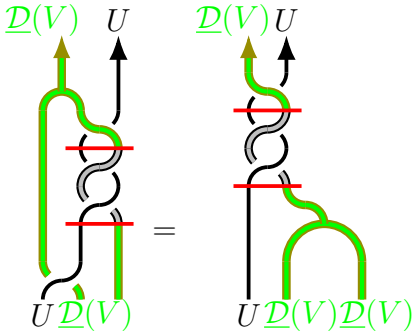
(3.21)

The first equality in (2.60) then follows from the fact that $\underline{f}$ is a morphism in $\mathcal{C}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)}$, and the naturality of the small braidings:



(3.22)

The second equality in (2.60) is depicted



(3.23)

We show that this holds via a direct calculation.

We begin by evaluating the right-hand side of (3.23) on a vector in $U\otimes(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)\otimes\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V))$. First we show that the morphism

$$\begin{aligned}\phi_{U,V} : U\otimes(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)\otimes\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)) &\to \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,(U\otimes\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V))\otimes V)\,,\\ u\otimes(f\otimes g) &\mapsto (v\mapsto (u\otimes f)\otimes g(v))\end{aligned} \tag{3.24}$$

is such that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U \otimes (\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)) & \xrightarrow{U \otimes m} & U \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle \phi_{U,V}} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \Phi_{U,V}} \\ \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, (U \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)) \otimes V) & \xrightarrow{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, U \otimes \mathrm{ev}_{V,V})} & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, U \otimes V) \end{array} \tag{3.25}$$

commutes. Indeed,

$$\begin{aligned} \Phi_{U,V} \circ (U \otimes m)(u \otimes a \otimes b) &= (v \mapsto u \otimes (a \circ b)(v)) \\ &= (v \mapsto u \otimes a(b(v))) \\ &= (v \mapsto u \otimes \mathrm{ev}_{V,V}(a \otimes b)(v)) \\ &= \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, U \otimes \mathrm{ev}_{V,V}) \circ \phi_{U,V}(u \otimes a \otimes b) \end{aligned} \tag{3.26}$$

for all $u \in U$ and $a, b \in \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$. Naturality of the small braiding implies the right-hand side of (3.23) is equal to

$$\overrightarrow{\sigma}^{-1}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V),U} \circ \Phi^{-1}_{U,V} \circ \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{V,U} \circ (\mathrm{ev}_{V,V} \otimes U) \circ \overleftarrow{\sigma}_{U,\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \otimes V}) \circ \phi_{U,V} \ . \tag{3.27}$$

Evaluating this on $u \otimes a \otimes b \in U \otimes (\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V))$ and using the hexagons (namely, (3.17)), we find

$$\begin{aligned} u \otimes a \otimes b &\xmapsto{\phi_{U,V}} (v \mapsto (u \otimes a) \otimes b(v)) \\ &\xmapsto{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \overleftarrow{\sigma}_{U,\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \otimes V})} (v \mapsto \mathcal{R}_2 a \otimes \mathcal{R}'_2 b(v) \otimes \mathcal{R}'_1 \mathcal{R}_1 u) \\ &\xmapsto{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \mathrm{ev}_{V,V} \otimes U)} (v \mapsto \mathcal{R}_2 a(\mathcal{R}'_2 b(v)) \otimes \mathcal{R}'_1 \mathcal{R}_1 u) \\ &\xmapsto{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{V,U})} (v \mapsto \mathcal{R}''_2 \mathcal{R}'_1 \mathcal{R}_1 u \otimes \mathcal{R}''_1 \mathcal{R}_2 a(\mathcal{R}'_2 b(v))) \\ &\xmapsto{\Phi^{-1}_{U,V}} \mathcal{R}''_2 \mathcal{R}'_1 \mathcal{R}_1 u \otimes \mathcal{R}''_1 \mathcal{R}_2 a(\mathcal{R}'_2 b(-)) \\ &\xmapsto{\overrightarrow{\sigma}^{-1}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V),U}} \mathcal{R}_2 a(\mathcal{R}'_2 b(-)) \otimes \mathcal{R}'_1 \mathcal{R}_1 u \ . \end{aligned} \tag{3.28}$$

Evaluating the left-hand side of (3.23) on $u \otimes a \otimes b$,

$$\begin{aligned}
u \otimes a \otimes b &\xmapsto{\overleftarrow{\sigma}_{U,\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)} \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)} \mathcal{R}_2 \cdot a \otimes \mathcal{R}_1 u \otimes b \\
&\xmapsto{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \otimes \Phi_{U,V}} \mathcal{R}_2 \cdot a \otimes (v \mapsto \mathcal{R}_1 u \otimes b(v)) \\
&\xmapsto{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{V,U} \overleftarrow{\sigma}_{U,V})} \mathcal{R}_2 \cdot a \otimes (v \mapsto \mathcal{R}_2'' \mathcal{R}_1' \mathcal{R}_1 u \otimes \mathcal{R}_1'' \mathcal{R}_2' b(v)) \\
&\xmapsto{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \otimes \Phi_{U,V}^{-1}} \mathcal{R}_2 \cdot a \otimes \mathcal{R}_2'' \mathcal{R}_1' \mathcal{R}_1 u \otimes \mathcal{R}_1'' \mathcal{R}_2' b \\
&\xmapsto{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \otimes \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}},U}^{-1})} \mathcal{R}_2 \cdot a \otimes \mathcal{R}_2' b \otimes \mathcal{R}_1' \mathcal{R}_1 u \\
&\xmapsto{m \otimes U} \mathcal{R}_2 a(\mathcal{R}_2' b(-)) \otimes \mathcal{R}_1' \mathcal{R}_1 u \,, \qquad (3.29)
\end{aligned}$$

which is equal to (3.28), as desired.

The proof that $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M, -)$ is a braided module functor follows from an almost identical computation. All one need do is replace the left $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)$ strand in (3.23) with a $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)$-module, and apply the unit to the right strand. □

Remark 3.9. Let H be a quasitriangular Hopf algebra over a commutative ring K. Proposition 3.8 also holds for $\mathcal{D}$ being the category of H-modules and $\mathcal{C}$ the category of finite-dimensional H-modules, with the monoidal structure given by the tensor product over K. The proof is exactly the same.

It is well-known that $\mathcal{C}$ is a ribbon category, see for example [Ka95, Sec. XVII.3]. In fact, $\mathcal{C}$ is the full monoidal subcategory of rigid objects in $\mathcal{D}$. Furthermore, the coend $\mathcal{L} = \int^{V \in \mathcal{C}} V^* \otimes V$ exists in $\mathcal{D}$, and is given by the so-called *braided dual* [Kel23, pp. 26] (see also [BZBJ18a, Sec. 6] for the braided dual in a related setting). We then arrive at the following source of quantum moment maps coming from $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules.

Theorem 3.10. Let $\mathcal{D}$ be the category of topologically-free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules and $\mathcal{C}$ the category of finite-dimensional $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-modules. For all $V \in \mathcal{D}$, the morphism $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$ defined via

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
U^* \otimes U & \xrightarrow{(U^* \otimes U) \otimes u_V} & (U^* \otimes U) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & U^* \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, U \otimes V) \\
\downarrow{\scriptstyle i_U} & & & & \\
\mathcal{L} & & & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle U^* \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \overrightarrow{\sigma}_{V,U} \overleftarrow{\sigma}_{U,V})} \\
\vdots{\scriptstyle \mu} & & & & \\
\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) & \xleftarrow[\mathrm{ev}_U \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)]{} & (U^* \otimes U) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) & \xleftarrow[\sim]{} & U^* \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, U \otimes V)
\end{array} \qquad (3.30)$$

is a quantum moment map. Taking V to be a generalised Verma module, the quantum moment map $\mu : \mathcal{L} \to \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$ recovers the quantised conjugacy classes of Lie groups defined in [Mu07].

Proof. Applying Proposition 2.23 we immediately have that μ is a quantum moment map.

To relate this to the results of [Mu07], we begin by writing the explicit form of $\mu \circ i_U(f \otimes u)$ as an endomorphism of V. This is

$$\mu \circ i_U(f \otimes u) = (v \mapsto f(\mathcal{R}'_2 \mathcal{R}_1 u)\mathcal{R}'_1 \mathcal{R}_2 v) \ . \tag{3.31}$$

for all $v \in V$. Taking V to be a generalised Verma module, the map

$$\varphi : \mathcal{L} \to U_\hbar\mathfrak{g} \ , \quad i_U(f \otimes u) \mapsto f(\mathcal{R}'_2 \mathcal{R}_1 u)\mathcal{R}'_1 \mathcal{R}_2 \tag{3.32}$$

is precisely [Mu07, Eq. (20)]. The composition of φ with the $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$-module structure of V is by definition [Mu07, Eq. (22)], and coincides with μ defined via (3.31). □

The representation theory of topologically-free $U_\hbar\mathfrak{g}$ weight modules is analogous to the theory type-I $U_q^H\mathfrak{g}$-modules at generic q. That is to say, the examples in Section 3.2 make sense here as well (in particular, the tensor product decomposition of Proposition 3.6 follows from [Mu07, Prop. 3.7]). Moreover, we can now define quantum moment maps for these examples. Because of the decomposition in (3.8), given any $\lambda \in \Lambda$ there exists $W \in \mathcal{C}$ and a surjection $W \otimes V(\lambda) \to V(\mu)$ for all $\mu \in \Lambda$, which implies $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda$ satisfies the conditions of $\mathcal{M}$ in Proposition A.7. Applying Proposition A.7 and Theorem 3.10 we of inclusions of braided module categories from $\mathcal{M}_\Lambda$:

Proposition 3.11. For all $\lambda \in \Lambda$, consider $\mathcal{D}_{A_\lambda}$ where $A_\lambda = \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V(\lambda))$ as a braided $\mathcal{C}$-module category, where the braiding is constructed from the quantum moment map obtained via Proposition 2.15. There is a full inclusion of braided module categories $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V(\lambda), -) : \mathcal{M}_\Lambda \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}_{A_\lambda}$.

A Closed monoidal categories

We recall the definition and some basic facts about closed monoidal categories. We refer the reader to [EK65] for proofs of the general statements.

Definition A.1. [EK65, Sec. II.2 & Thm. II.5.3] A monoidal category $\mathcal{D}$ is *closed* if the functor $- \otimes V : \mathcal{D} \to \mathcal{D}$ has a right adjoint $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, -)$ for all $V \in \mathcal{D}$. That is, for all $U, V, W \in \mathcal{D}$ there is a natural isomorphism $\mathcal{D}(U \otimes V, W) \cong \mathcal{D}(U, \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, W))$.

Let $\mathcal{D}$ be a closed monoidal category in the remainder of the appendix. Given $f \in \mathcal{D}(U \otimes V, W)$ we denote with $f' \in \mathcal{D}(U, \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, W))$ the image of f under the isomorphism $\mathcal{D}(U \otimes V, W) \to \mathcal{D}(U, \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, W))$. The internal-hom objects $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, W)$ come equipped with extra structure, which we now describe. The proofs of Lemmas A.2 and A.3 can be found in [EK65, Sec. II.3].

For each $V \in \mathcal{D}$, define the canonical natural transformations

$$\mathrm{ev}_{V,-} : \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, -) \otimes V \Rightarrow - \quad \text{and} \quad \mathrm{coev}_{-,V} : - \Rightarrow \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, - \otimes V) \tag{A.1}$$

to be the images of the identity morphisms under the isomorphisms

$$\mathcal{D}(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, -), \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, -)) \Rightarrow \mathcal{D}(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, -) \otimes V, -) \,, \tag{A.2}$$

and

$$\mathcal{D}(- \otimes V, - \otimes V) \Rightarrow \mathcal{D}(-, \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, - \otimes V)) \,, \tag{A.3}$$

respectively.

Lemma A.2. The natural transformations $\mathrm{ev}_{V,-}$ and $\mathrm{coev}_{-,V}$ are such that the diagrams

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U & \xrightarrow{f'} & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, W) \\ & {\scriptstyle \mathrm{coev}_{U,V}} \searrow & \uparrow {\scriptstyle \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, f)} \\ & & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, U \otimes V) \end{array} \quad , \qquad \begin{array}{ccc} U \otimes V & \xrightarrow{f} & W \\ & {\scriptstyle f' \otimes V} \searrow & \uparrow {\scriptstyle \mathrm{ev}_{V,W}} \\ & & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, W) \otimes V \end{array} \tag{A.4}$$

commute for all $U, V, W \in \mathcal{D}$ and $f \in \mathcal{D}(U \otimes V, W)$.

For all $U, V, W, X \in \mathcal{D}$ there are canonical morphisms

$$m^W_{U,V} : \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(W, U) \to \underline{\mathcal{D}}(W, V) \,, \tag{A.5}$$

given by the image of

$$\mathrm{ev}_{U,V} \circ (\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V) \otimes \mathrm{ev}_{W,U}) : \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V) \otimes (\underline{\mathcal{D}}(W, U) \otimes W) \to V \tag{A.6}$$

under the isomorphism

$$\mathcal{D}(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V) \otimes (\underline{\mathcal{D}}(W, U) \otimes W), V) \to \mathcal{D}(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(W, U), \underline{\mathcal{D}}(W, V)) \,. \tag{A.7}$$

Lemma A.3. The morphisms $m^W_{U,V}$ are such that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(X, U) & & \\ & {\scriptstyle \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,V) \otimes m^X_{W,U}} \nearrow & & \searrow {\scriptstyle m^X_{U,V}} & \\ \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V) \otimes (\underline{\mathcal{D}}(W, U) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(X, W)) & & & & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(X, V) \\ {\scriptstyle \sim}\downarrow & & & & \uparrow {\scriptstyle m^X_{W,V}} \\ (\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(W, U)) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(X, W) & & \xrightarrow[m^W_{U,V} \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(X,W)]{} & & \underline{\mathcal{D}}(W, V) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(X, W) \end{array} \tag{A.8}$$

commutes.

Denote with u_V the composition

$$\mathbb{1} \xrightarrow{\mathrm{coev}_{\mathbb{1},V}} \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \mathbb{1} \otimes V) \xrightarrow{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, l_V)} \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, V) =: \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \,. \tag{A.9}$$

Using Lemmas A.2 and A.3 we construct algebras and bimodules in $\mathcal{D}$ from the internal-hom objects:

Corollary A.4. For all $U, V \in \mathcal{D}$, each tuple $(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V), m^V_{V,V}, u_V)$ is an algebra in $\mathcal{D}$, which we refer to simply as $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V)$. Each tuple $(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,V), m^V_{U,V}, m^V_{U,V})$ is a $(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V), \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U))$-bimodule in $\mathcal{D}$.

Define the natural transformation $\Phi^{\equiv}_{-,=} : - \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(\equiv, =) \to \underline{\mathcal{D}}(\equiv, - \otimes =)$ via the composition

$$\Phi^U_{V,W} : V \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,W) \xrightarrow{\mathrm{coev}_{V,W} \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,W)} \underline{\mathcal{D}}(W, V \otimes W) \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,W) \xrightarrow{m^U_{W,V\otimes W}} \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V \otimes W) \,. \tag{A.10}$$

The following lemma is an approximation to [EGNO15, Lem. 7.9.4] in our setting.

Lemma A.5. The natural transformation $\Phi^{=}_{V,-}$ is an isomorphism if and only if V has a left-dual in $\mathcal{D}$.

Proof. Let $U, V, W \in \mathcal{D}$ and V be rigid. For all $X \in \mathcal{D}$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{D}(X \otimes U, V \otimes W) &\cong \mathcal{D}(V^* \otimes (X \otimes U), W) \\ &\cong \mathcal{D}((V^* \otimes X) \otimes U, W) \\ &\cong \mathcal{D}(V^* \otimes X, \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, W)) \\ &\cong \mathcal{D}(X, V \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, W)) \,. \end{aligned} \tag{A.11}$$

By definition of the internal-hom, we also have

$$\mathcal{D}(X \otimes U, V \otimes W) \cong \mathcal{D}(X, \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V \otimes W)) \,. \tag{A.12}$$

Hence, by the Yoneda Lemma, we have $V \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,W) \cong \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U, V \otimes W)$. Furthermore, this isomorphism exhibits $V \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(U,W)$ as representing $\mathcal{D}(- \otimes U, V \otimes W)$, making it exactly $\Phi^U_{V,W}$.

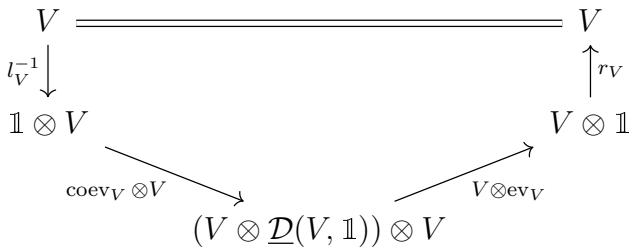
Assume $\Phi^{=}_{V,-}$ is an isomorphism. Let $U, V, W \in \mathcal{D}$ and consider the object $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \mathbb{1})$. We have evaluation and coevaluation morphisms given by

$$\mathrm{ev}_V := \mathrm{ev}_{V,\mathbb{1}} : \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \mathbb{1}) \otimes V \to \mathbb{1} \tag{A.13}$$

and

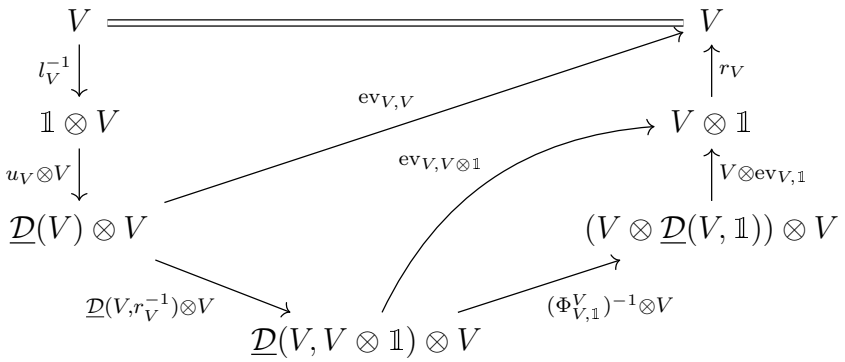
$$\mathrm{coev}_V : \mathbb{1} \xrightarrow{u_V} \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V) \xrightarrow{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, r_V^{-1})} \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, V \otimes \mathbb{1}) \xrightarrow{(\Phi^V_{V,\mathbb{1}})^{-1}} V \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, \mathbb{1}) \,. \tag{A.14}$$

We need to check the zig-zag identities. For brevity we will suppress the associators in what follows. We will check the identity



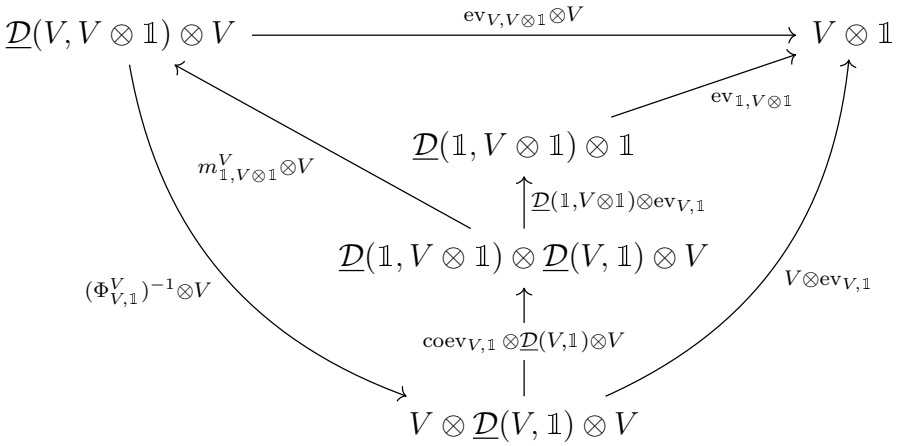
(A.15)

The other identity follows via a similar computation. The diagram (A.15) is equivalent to the outside pentagon of



(A.16)

The square in the top left of (A.16) commutes from the second diagram in Lemma A.2 and the definition of u_V, and the square in the middle from the naturality of $\mathrm{ev}_{V,-}$. It remains to show that the bottom right triangle in (A.16) commutes. This triangle is the outside of the diagram



(A.17)

The triangle on the bottom left of (A.17) commutes by the definition of $\Phi^V_{V,\mathbb{1}}$, and the upper left square of (A.17) commutes from the definition of $m^V_{\mathbb{1},V\otimes\mathbb{1}}$ and the

second diagram in Lemma A.2. The remaining square in (A.17) can be reshaped into

$$V \otimes \underline{\mathcal{D}}(V,\mathbb{1}) \otimes V \xrightarrow{V\otimes \mathrm{ev}_{V,\mathbb{1}}} V \otimes \mathbb{1} \underset{\mathrm{ev}_{\mathbb{1},V\otimes\mathbb{1}}}{\overset{\mathrm{coev}_{V,\mathbb{1}}\otimes\mathbb{1}}{\rightleftarrows}} \underline{\mathcal{D}}(\mathbb{1},V\otimes\mathbb{1})\otimes\mathbb{1} \quad . \tag{A.18}$$

The loop in (A.18) is a special case of [EK65, Eq. (3.6)], so (A.17) commutes. □

Assume henceforth that $\mathcal{D}$ is abelian and has a right-exact tensor product. Let $\mathcal{C} \subset \mathcal{D}$ be a full rigid monoidal subcategory of $\mathcal{D}$. For the remainder of the subsection, fix a full subcategory $\mathcal{M} \subset \mathcal{D}$ which is closed under tensoring with objects in $\mathcal{C}$, making $\mathcal{M}$ a $\mathcal{C}$-module category. Given $M \in \mathcal{M}$, we consider the algebra $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)$ and the $\mathcal{D}$-module category $\mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}$. By virtue of the fact that $\mathcal{C}$ is a monoidal subcategory of $\mathcal{D}$, the category $\mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}$ is also a $\mathcal{C}$-module category. Consider the functor $\mathcal{D}(M,-) : \mathcal{M} \to \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}$. The following is a corollary of Lemma A.5

Lemma A.6. Given $M \in \mathcal{M}$, the natural isomorphism $\Phi^M_{-,=}$ gives the functor

$$\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,-) : \mathcal{M} \to \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)} \ , \quad N \mapsto \underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,N) \tag{A.19}$$

the structure of a $\mathcal{C}$-module functor.

The following proposition is in the spirit of the characterisation given in [EGNO15, Thm. 7.10.1] in the non-finite and non-rigid setting. The proof is exactly that in steps (1) and (2) of the proof given for [EGNO15, Thm. 7.10.1], however our assumptions differ so we repeat it here.

Proposition A.7. Let there be $M \in \mathcal{M}$, such that for $N \in \mathcal{M}$ there exists $U \in \mathcal{C}$ and an epimorphism $U \otimes M \to N$. Assume also that $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,-)$ is right exact. Then the $\mathcal{C}$-module functor $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,-) : \mathcal{M} \to \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}$ is fully faithful.

Proof. Say $N \in \mathcal{M}$ is of the form $U \otimes M$ for some $U \in \mathcal{C}$. Given $L \in \mathcal{M}$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}(\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,U\otimes M),\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,L)) &\cong \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}(U\otimes\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M),\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,L)) \\ &\cong \mathcal{D}(U,\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M,L)) \\ &\cong \mathcal{M}(U\otimes M,L) \\ &= \mathcal{M}(N,L) \ , \end{aligned} \tag{A.20}$$

where the second line follows from the fact that $\mathcal{D}_A(X\otimes A,B) \cong \mathcal{D}(A,B)$ for all $X \in \mathcal{D}$, and any algebra $A \in \mathcal{D}$, and all $B \in \mathcal{D}_A$.

The condition on $\mathcal{M}$ and the fact that $F := \underline{\mathcal{D}}(M, -)$ is right exact implies that for all $N \in \mathcal{M}$ there are $U, W \in \mathcal{D}$ such that each row of the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} U \otimes M & \longrightarrow & W \otimes M & \longrightarrow & N & \longrightarrow & 0 \\ {\scriptstyle F}\downarrow & & {\scriptstyle F}\downarrow & & {\scriptstyle F}\downarrow & & \\ F(U \otimes M) & \longrightarrow & F(W \otimes M) & \longrightarrow & F(N) & \longrightarrow & 0 \end{array} \tag{A.21}$$

is exact. Because $\mathcal{M}$ is a full subcategory of $\mathcal{D}$, and $\mathcal{D}$ is abelian, the (contravariant) hom functors $\mathcal{M}(-, L)$ are left exact for all $L \in \mathcal{M}$. Hence each row of the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{M}(N, L) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{M}(W \otimes M, L) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{M}(U \otimes M, L) \\ & & {\scriptstyle F}\downarrow & & {\scriptstyle F}\downarrow & & {\scriptstyle F}\downarrow \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}(F(N), F(L)) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}(F(W \otimes M), F(L)) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}(F(U \otimes M), F(L)) \end{array} \tag{A.22}$$

is exact. From (A.20) we know that the second and third vertical arrows are isomorphisms, hence the first vertical arrow is an isomorphism. Thus $F = \underline{\mathcal{D}}(M, -)$ is fully-faithful. □

Remark A.8. An obstruction to $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(V, -)$ being an equivalence of $\mathcal{C}$-module categories is that if $\mathcal{M}$ is not equivalent to $\mathcal{D}$ the functor $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M, -)$ cannot be essentially surjective. To see this, consider $\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M, W) \in \mathcal{D}_{\underline{\mathcal{D}}(M)}$ where $W \notin \mathcal{M}$.

References

[AM14] H. H. Andersen, V. Mazorchuk, *Category $\mathcal{O}$ for quantum groups*, Journal of the European Mathematical Society, **17** (2015): 405-–431 `arXiv:1105.5500` [math.RT].

[B79] M. Barr, *-*Autonomous Categories*, Lecture Notes in Mathematics, **752** (1979), Springer-Verlag, Berlin.

[BZBJ18a] D. Ben-Zvi, A. Brochier, D. Jordan, *Integrating quantum groups over surfaces*, Journal of Topology, **11** (2018):874—917 `arXiv:1501.04652` [math.QA].

[BZBJ18b] D. Ben-Zvi, A. Brochier, D. Jordan, *Quantum character varieties and braided module categories*, Selecta Mathematica, **24** (2018):4711—4748 `arXiv:1606.04769` [math.QA].

[BJS18] A. Brochier, D. Jordan, N. Snyder *On dualizability of braided tensor categories*, Compositio Mathematica, **157** (2021):435-483 arXiv:1804.07538 [math.QA].

[Br13] A. Brochier, *Cyclotomic associators and finite type 1nvariants for tangles in the solid torus*, Algebraic & Geometric Topology, **13** (2013): 3365—3409 arXiv:1209.0417 [math.QA].

[BJ25] J. Brown, D. Jordan, *Parabolic skein modules*, arXiv:2505.14836 [math.QA].

[BGJM26] J. Brown, J. R. G. García, D. Jordan, M. Vancraeynest, *Weyl defects in skein theory and quantum cluster charts*, arXiv:2609.09308 [math.QA].

[Ch94] V. Chari, *Minimal Affinizations of Representations of quantum groups: the $U_q(\mathfrak{g})$-module structure*, arXiv:hep-th/9411144 [hep-th].

[CP95] V. Chari, A. N. Presley, *A Guide to Quantum Groups*, Cambridge University Press (1994), Cambridge.

[CJR26] E. Y.-Y. Chen, D. Jordan, I. Romaidis, *Skein theory, line defects, and quantum symmetric pairs*, arXiv:2609.18902 [math.QA].

[CGS22] D. Chernyak, A. M. Gainutdinov, H. Saleur, *$U_q\mathfrak{sl}_2$-invariant non-compact boundary conditions for the XXZ spin chain*, Journal of High Energy Physics, **2022** (2022): 16 arXiv:2207.12772 [hep-th].

[CGP14] F. Costantino, N. Geer, B. Patureau-Mirand, *Some remarks on the unrolled quantum group of $\mathfrak{sl}(2)$*, Journal of Pure and Applied Algebra, **219** (2015):3238-3262 arXiv:1406.0410 [math.QA].

[CL25] J. Cooke, R. Laugwitz, *Presentations for small reflection equation algebras of type A*, Journal of Algebra, **682** (2025): 131-187 arXiv:2412.16004 [math.QA].

[DCK90] C. De Concini, V. G. Kac, *Representations of Quantum Groups at Roots of 1*, Progress in Mathematics, **92** (1990): 131-187.

[DN21] A. Davydov, D. Nikshych, *Braided Picard groups and graded extensions of braided tensor categories*, Selecta Mathematica, **27** (2021): 65 arXiv:2006.08022 [math.QA].

[DKM03] J. Donin, P. P. Kulish, A. I. Mudrov, *On universal solution to reflection equation*, Letters in Mathematical Physics, **63** (2003): 179-194 arXiv:math/0210242 [math.QA].

[DM02] J. Donin, A. I. Mudrov, *Explicit equivariant quantization on (co)adjoint orbits of $GL(n, \mathbb{C})$*, Letters in Mathematical Physics, **62** (2002): 17-32 arXiv:math/0206049 [math.QA].

[EK65] S. Eilenberg, G. M. Kelly, *Closed Categories*, Proceedings of the Conference on Categorical Algebra - La Jolla 1965, (1966): 421-562.

[EGNO15] P. Etingof, S. Gelaki, D. Nikshych, V. Ostrik, *Tensor Categories*, Mathematical Surveys and Monographs, **205** (2015), American Mathematical Society, Providence, RI.

[En08] B. Enriquez, *Quasi-reflection algebras and cyclotomic associators*, Selecta Mathematica, **19** (2008): 391 arXiv:math/0408035 [math.QA].

[ES00] P. Etingof, O. Schiffmann, *Lectures on the dynamical Yang-Baxter equations*, arXiv:math/9908064 [math.QA].

[FHW15] V. Futorny, J. Hartwig, E. Wilson, *Irreducible completely pointed modules of quantum groups of type A*, Journal of Algebra, **432** (2015): 252-279 arXiv:1404.0305v2 [math.RT].

[G26] J. R. G. García, *HOMFLY parabolic restriction, defect skein theory and the Turaev coproduct*, arXiv:2601.03196 [math.QA].

[GJS23] S. Gunningham, D. Jordan, P. Safronov, *The finiteness conjecture for skein modules*, Inventiones mathematicae, **232** (2023): 301-363 arXiv:1908.05233 [math.QA].

[GPT07] N. Geer, B. Patureau-Mirand, V. Turaev, *Modified quantum dimensions and re-normalized link invariants*, Compositio Mathematica, **145** (2009): 196-212 arXiv:0711.4229 [math.QA].

[GP10] N. Geer, B. Patureau-Mirand *Topological invariants from non-restricted quantum groups*, Algebraic & Geometric Topology **13** (2013): 3305–3363 arXiv:1009.4120 [math.GT].

[HS26] A. Hofstetter, C. Schweigert, *The 2-categorical S-matrix of a braided fusion 1-category is a character table*, arXiv:2601.14168 [math.QA].

[ILZ19] K. Iohara, G. Lehrer, R. Zhang, *Schur-Weyl duality for certain infinite dimensional $U_q(\mathfrak{sl}_2)$-modules*, arXiv:1811.01325 [math.RT].

[JFR23] T. Johnson-Freyd, D. Reutter, *Minimal nondegenerate extensions*, Journal of the American Mathematical Society, **37** (2023): 81-150 arXiv:2105.15167 [math.QA].

[Jo23] D. Jordan, *Langlands duality for skein modules of 3-manifolds*, arXiv:2302.14734 [math.QA].

[JS93] A. Joyal, R. Street, *Braided tensor categories*, Advances in Mathematics **102** (1993), 20-78.

[KS20] A. Kalmykov,P. Safronov, *A categorical approach to dynamical quantum groups*, Forum of Mathematics, Sigma, **10** (2020):e76 arXiv:2008.09081 [math.RT].

[Ka95] C. Kassel, *Quantum Groups*, Graduate Texts in Mathematics **155**, Springer-Verlag, New York, 1995.

[Kel23] C. Keller, *Generalized Character Varieties and Quantization via Factorization Homology*, Ph.D. thesis, Université de Montpellier (2023). https://imag.umontpellier.fr/~calaque/students-Corina_Keller_PhD_Thesis.pdf.

[KR26] P. Kinnear, I. Runkel, *Defects in skein theory and TQFT*, arXiv:2606.07432 [math.QA].

[KL01] T. Kerler, V. V. Lyubashenko, *Non-Semisimple Topological Quantum Field Theories for 3-Manifolds with Corners*, Lecture Notes in Mathematics **1765** (2001), Springer-Verlag, Berlin.

[KS97] A. Klimyk, K. Schmudgen, *Quantum groups and their representations*, Theoretical and Mathematical Physics (1997), Springer-Verlag, Berlin.

[Ko17] S. Kolb, *Braided module categories via quantum symmetric pairs*, Proceedings of the London Mathematical Society, **121** (2020):1-31 arXiv:1705.04238 [math.QA].

[Ko00] T. H. Koornwinder, *Some details of proofs of theorems related to the quantum dynamical Yang-Baxter equation*, arXiv:math/0007079 [math.QA].

[LNV21] A. Lacabanne, G. Naisse, P. Vaz, *Tensor product categorifications, Verma modules and the blob 2-category*, Quantum Topology, **12** (2021):705-812 arXiv:2005.06257 [math.QA].

[LWY23] R. Laugwitz, C. Walton, M. Yakimov, *Reflective centers of module categories and quantum K-matrices*, Forum of Mathematics, Sigma, **13** (2025):e95 arXiv:2307.14764 [math.QA].

[Ly96] V. Lyubashenko, *Ribbon Abelian Categories as Modular Categories*, Journal of Knot Theory and Its Ramifications, **05.03** (1996):311-403.

[Ma95] S. Majid, *Foundations of Quantum Group Theory*, Cambridge University Press (1995).

[MS94] P. Martin, H. Saleur, *The blob algebra and the periodic Temperley-Lieb algebra*, Letters in Mathematical Physics, **30** (1994):189-206 arXiv:hep-th/9302094 [hep-th].

[Mu07] A. Mudrov, *Quantum Conjugacy Classes of Simple Matrix Groups*, Communications in Mathematical Physics, **272** (2007):635-660 arXiv:math/0412538 [math.QA].

[Ru19] M. Rupert, *Categories of Weight Modules for Unrolled Restricted Quantum Groups at Roots of Unity*, Izvestiya: Mathematics, **86** (2022):1204-1224 arXiv:1910.05922 [math.RT].

[SZ26] M. Stroiński, T. Zorman, *Reconstruction of module categories in the infinite and non-rigid settings*, arXiv:2409.00793 [math.QA].

[SZ24] C. Stroppel, Z. Wojciechowski, *Diagrammatics for the smallest quantum coideal and Jones–Wenzl projectors*, Glasgow Mathematical Journal, **68** (2025):1-20 arXiv:2406.12132v1 [math.RT].

[Ti10] P. Tingley, *A minus sign that used to annoy me but now I know why it is there*, arXiv:1002.0555 [math.GT].